

حَقِيقَةُ الْخُلُوفِ
فِي وَجْهِ الْفَلَاحِ

أَنْفِ الْبَنَاتِ
يَوْمَ يَنْفَعُنَّ الْيَمَانُ

حَقِيقَةُ
النَّمْرِ ثَمَانِ
الْجَلَدِ يَدْرِي

THE
REALITY OF
CREATION
IN FACE OF THE
HEAVENLY ORBIT

REFUTING THE PSEUDO-ASTRONOMERS
WITH THE QURAN AND SUNNAH
THROUGH THE INTERPRETATION
OF THE EARLY AND LATER SCHOLARS

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FLATNESS

الَّذِي جَعَلَ لَكُمُ الْأَرْضَ فِرَاشًا وَالسَّمَاءَ بِنَاءً وَأَنْزَلَ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ مَاءً فَأَخْرَجَ بِهِ مِنَ الثَّمَرَاتِ رِزْقًا لَكُمْ فَلَا تَجْعَلُوا لِلَّهِ أَنْدَادًا وَأَنْتُمْ تَعْلَمُونَ
[He] who made for you the earth a bed [spread out] and the sky a ceiling and sent down from the sky, rain and brought forth thereby fruits as provision for you. So do not attribute to Allāh equals while you know [that there is nothing similar to Him]. (2:22)

"Ibn Mas'ud and people from the Companions, regarding His words [the verse]: He said: "It is a firash (bed or mattress) upon which you walk. And it is the mihad (bed or flat land) and the qarar (firm and fixed place). And the heaven is the ceiling." [Al-Durr al-Manthur]

"The statement, "this does not require it to be flat because its spherical shape, with its great size and wide mass, does not prevent spreading out on it," even if its intention is correct, it's being flat is still preferable because it is the choice of ibn Abbas from ibn Umar." [Tafseer al-Baydawi]

"It is spread out and extended on the surface of the earth... Allah informed them to what is [required] in spreading out the earth and its expansion and building the sky (firmament) and its elevation of lessons and signs indicating its existence and requiring a Creator who is Capable, Knowing, Living, and Choosing. And in the verse is evidence that the earth is extended/stretched and not in the shape of a ball." [al-Tayseer fi Ilm al-Tafseer of al-Qushayri]

وَكَذَلِكَ جَعَلْنَاكُمْ أُمَّةً وَسَطًا لِتَكُونُوا شُهَدَاءَ عَلَى النَّاسِ وَيَكُونَ الرَّسُولُ عَلَيْكُمْ شَهِيدًا ۗ وَمَا جَعَلْنَا الْقِبْلَةَ الَّتِي كُنْتَ عَلَيْهَا إِلَّا لِنَعْلَمَ مَنْ يَبْتِغِ
الرَّسُولَ مِمَّنْ يَنْقَلِبُ عَلَى عَقْبَيْهِ ۚ

And thus We have made you a middle nation that you will be witnesses over the people and the Messenger will be a witness over you. And We did not make the qiblah which you used to face except that We might make evident who would follow the Messenger from who would turn back on his heels. (2:143)

"Meaning: Just as the Kaabah is the center of the earth, so too have We made you a middle nation." [Tafseer al-Qurtubi 2/153]

وَسَارِعُوا إِلَىٰ مَغْفِرَةٍ مِّن رَّبِّكُمْ وَجَنَّةٍ عَرْضُهَا السَّمَاوَاتُ وَالْأَرْضُ أُعِدَّتْ لِلْمُتَّقِينَ

And hasten to forgiveness from your Lord and a garden [i.e. Paradise] as wide as the heavens and earth, prepared for the righteous. (3:133)

"Ibn Abbas said: It is as if the heavens and the earth are put together and joined together, like garments spread out and attached to one another. That is the width of Paradise, and no one knows its length except Allah. This is the view of the majority, and it is nothing strange." [Tafseer al-Qurtubi 4/204]

"The majority of scholars are of the view that it is as if the heavens and the earth are put together and joined together, like garments spread out and attached to one another, and that is the width of Paradise. The width is mentioned, but not the length, because usually the length is greater than the width." [Fath al-Qadeer 1/437]

وَهُوَ الَّذِي مَدَّ الْأَرْضَ وَجَعَلَ فِيهَا رُوسَى وَأَنْهَارًا وَمِنْ كُلِّ الثَّمَرَاتِ جَعَلَ فِيهَا رَوَجَيْنِ اثْنَيْنِ يُغْشَى اللَّيْلُ النَّهَارَ إِنَّ فِي ذَلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّقَوْمٍ يَتَفَكَّرُونَ

And it is He who spread the earth and placed therein firmly set mountains and rivers; and from all of the fruits He made therein two mates; He causes the night to cover the day. Indeed in that are signs for a people who give thought. (13:3)

"Hasan said: This is a parable that Allah has given for the hearts of the children of Adam. The earth was in the hand of the Most Gracious as a single clay, then He spread it out and leveled it {فَسَطَّحَهَا وَبَطَّحَهَا}, so the earth became separate pieces next to each other. Then water descends upon it from the sky..." [Tafseer al-Tabari]

"In this verse there is a response to those who claim that the earth is like a ball... For this reason, I hold this [as my stance] and the Muslims and the People of the Book state that the earth is static, still, and spread out, and its movement is usually through an earthquake [ie, it does not otherwise move]." [Tafseer al-Qurtubi 12/8-9]

"And it is He who spread out the earth," meaning He extended it for stability on it, in response to those who claimed that it is round like a ball." [Tafseer al-Mawardi 3/92]

"And He is the One who spread out the earth," meaning, He extended it over the surface of the water. It was said: The earth was gathered together, so He spread it out from under Bayt al-Haram. This statement is only correct if it is said that the earth is flat like the palms of the hands. According to the people of astronomy, the earth is a sphere, and it can be said that if the sphere is large and great, then every piece of it is seen extended like a large and great surface, so the gathering occurred. Despite that, Allah has informed us that He spread out the earth, and that He leveled it and spread it out, and all of that indicates flattening. Allah is more truthful in speech and clearer in evidence than the people of astronomy. [Tafseer al-Khazen 3/4]

"This indicates that the Earth is a flat surface like a palm. However, according to the astronomers, the Earth is undoubtedly a sphere, based on the evidence they possess... This can be reconciled by (saying flat in appearance) does not contradict its sphericity... Nevertheless, Allah has informed us that He extended the Earth, spread it out, and flattened it. All of this indicates the flattening, and Allah speaks the truth and provides a clearer proof than the scholars of astronomy." [Tafseer Hada'iq al-Ruh of al-Urumi al-Alawi]

وَالْأَرْضَ مَدَدْنَاهَا وَأَلْقَيْنَا فِيهَا رُوسَى وَأَنْبَتْنَا فِيهَا مِنْ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ مَّوْزُونٍ

And the earth - We have spread it and cast therein firmly set mountains and caused to grow therein [something] of every well-balanced thing. (15:19)

"The apparent meaning of (15:19) and "Wherein thou seest neither curve nor ruggedness" (20:107) and

(79:30) indicates that it is flat, and ibn Abbas and many scholars are more knowledgeable about the language and more aware of the statement, so there is no doubt that the inclination towards it is acceptable to those with knowledge." [Tafseer al-Baydawi]

"Meaning, "We have laid it out and spread it out," as in His statement: (79:30) and: (51:48). And in it is a refutation of those who claimed that it is like a ball." [Fath al-Qadeer of al-Shawkani 3/173]

الَّذِي جَعَلَ لَكُمُ الْأَرْضَ مَهْدًا وَسَلَكَ لَكُمْ فِيهَا سُبُلًا وَأَنْزَلَ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ مَاءً فَأَخْرَجْنَا بِهِ أَزْوَاجًا مِّنْ نَّبَاتٍ شَتَّى

[It is He] who has made for you the earth as a bed [spread out] and inserted therein for you roadways and sent down from the sky, rain and produced thereby categories of various plants. (20:53)

"Al-Hasan said: "This is a parable that Allah has given for the hearts of the children of Adam. The earth was in the hand of al-Rahman as a single clay, then He spread it out and leveled it, so the earth became neighboring plots."" [Tafseer al-Tabari]

وَيَسْأَلُونَكَ عَنِ الْجِبَالِ فَقُلْ يَنْسِفُهَا رَبِّي نَسْفًا ۖ ۱٠٥ فَيَذَرُهَا قَاعًا صَفْصَفًا ۖ ۱٠٦ لَا تَرَىٰ فِيهَا عِوَجًا وَلَا أَمْتًا ۖ ۱٠٧

And they ask you about the mountains, so say, "My Lord will blow them away with a blast. And He will leave it [i.e., the earth] a level plain; You will not see therein a depression/curve or an elevation." (20:105-107)

"He will leave them as a level plain." A level plain is a smooth plain, without plants or buildings. It was also said that the flat part of the earth is as if it were in a single row in its flatness; this was stated by Mujahid. The meaning is the same for both the "basement" and the "basement." A base is an exposed place, while a "basement" is a smooth, flat place." [Tafseer al-Qurtubi]

"Meaning the land, "a flat plain," meaning a single carpet. This is why He said: "You will not see therein any crookedness or unevenness," meaning: You will not see on the land on that Day any valley or hill, nor any low or high place. This is what ibn Abbas, Ikrimah, Mujahid, Hasan al-Basri, al-Dhahhak, Qatadah, and many others among the Salaf said." [Tafseer ibn Kathir]

الَّذِي جَعَلَ لَكُمُ الْأَرْضَ مَهْدًا وَجَعَلَ لَكُمْ فِيهَا سُبُلًا لَّعَلَّكُمْ تَهْتَدُونَ

[The one] who has made for you the earth a bed (laid out) and made for you upon it roads that you might be guided. (43:10)

وَالْأَرْضَ مَدَدْنَاهَا وَأَلْقَيْنَا فِيهَا رُوسِيَ وَأَنْبَتْنَا فِيهَا مِنْ كُلِّ زَوْجٍ بَهِيجٍ

And the earth - We spread it out and cast therein firmly set mountains and made grow therein [something] of every beautiful kind (50:7)

"It means We leveled it, and this is evidence that the Earth is flat and not in the shape of a sphere." [Ghara'ib al-Tafseer wa Aja'ib al-Ta'weel of al-Kermani]

"That is, 'We spread it out and placed it on the surface of the water,' as in (79:30) and (51:48). This verse denies the view of those who claim that the Earth is a sphere." [Fath al-Bayaan]

"In it is evidence that the Earth is expanded and not a ball." [Al-Ikleel fi al-Istinbaat al-Tanzeel of al-Suyuti]

وَالْأَرْضَ فَرَشْنَاهَا فَنِعْمَ الْمُوَدُّونَ

And the earth We have spread out, and excellent is the preparer/spreader. (51:48)

وَالْأَرْضَ وَضَعَهَا لِلْأَنَامِ

And the earth He laid [out] for the creatures. (55:10)

سَابِقُورًا إِلَىٰ مَغْفِرَةٍ مِّن رَّبِّكُمْ وَجَنَّةٍ عَرْضُهَا كَعَرْضِ السَّمَاءِ وَالْأَرْضِ أُعِدَّتْ لِلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا بِاللَّهِ وَرُسُلِهِ ۚ ذَٰلِكَ فَضْلُ اللَّهِ يُؤْتِيهِ مَن يَشَاءُ ۚ وَاللَّهُ ذُو الْفَضْلِ الْعَظِيمِ

Race [i.e., compete] toward forgiveness from your Lord and a Garden whose width is like the width of the heavens and earth (or, a Paradise as vast as the heavens and the earth), prepared for those who believed in Allah and His messengers. That is the bounty of Allah which He gives to whom He wills, and Allah is the possessor of great bounty. (57:21)

اللَّهُ الَّذِي خَلَقَ سَبْعَ سَمَاوَاتٍ وَمِنَ الْأَرْضِ مِثْلَهُنَّ يَتَنَزَّلُ الْأَمْرُ بَيْنَهُنَّ لِتَعْلَمُوا أَنَّ اللَّهَ عَلَىٰ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدِيرٌ وَأَنَّ اللَّهَ قَدْ أَحَاطَ بِكُلِّ شَيْءٍ عِلْمًا

It is Allah who has created seven heavens and of the earth, the like of them. [His] command descends among them so you may know that Allah is over all things competent and that Allah has encompassed all things in knowledge. (65:12)

وَاللَّهُ جَعَلَ لَكُمُ الْأَرْضَ بِسَاطًا

And Allah has made for you the earth a wide expanse (or, spread out the earth for you). (71:19)

"A carpet on which you roll over as a man rolls over on his carpet. It is obvious that the earth is not spherical, but rather it is a flat, smooth surface." [Al-Bahr al-Muhit of Abu Hayyan 20/534]

"Bisaat apparently implies that the Earth is either flat or spherical, and believing either of the two things is not inherently blameworthy. However, the view that it is spherical is corrupt. As for believing that it is flat, this is the obvious meaning of the Book of Allah, and it is what no corruption can be attributed to. Ibn Mujahid provided evidence for the validity of this with the seawater surrounding the inhabited world, and he said: "If the Earth were spherical, the water would not have settled on it."'" [Tafseer ibn Atiyyah]

أَلَمْ نَجْعَلِ الْأَرْضَ مِهْدًا

Have We not made the earth an expanse (or, have We not smoothed out the earth 'like a bed') (78:6)

وَالْأَرْضَ بَعْدَ ذَٰلِكَ دَحَاهَا

And after that He spread the earth. (79:30)

Editor's note: Arabic dictionaries record a definition of d-h-w as a stretched place where an ostrich lays its egg, rather than an egg shape itself.

"Ibn Abbas said: The House (the Ka'bah) was placed over the water on four pillars, two thousand years before this world was created, then the earth spread out from beneath the House." [Tafseer al-Tabari 3/61 with an acceptable isnaad]

Abdullah ibn 'Amr ibn al-'Aas said: Allah created the House (the Ka'bah) two thousand years before the earth ... then the earth spread out from beneath it. [Tafseer at-Tabari 6/20 with an isnaad of trustworthy narrators (thiqaat); al-Durr al-Manthoor 2/265; al-Tabarani and al-Bayhaqi in al-Shu'ab]

"That is: He expanded and prepared it for the habitation of its inhabitants and their movement across its regions. When it was created, it was an uninhabitable sphere. Then, a thousand years after the creation of the heavens, the earth was spread out from beneath Mecca. Then, the spread of the earth was explained as

follows...” [Tafseer al-Bahr al-Madeed of Ibn Ajeebah]

كَذَّآ إِنَّ كِتَابَ الْفُجَّارِ لَفِي سِجِّينٍ

No! Indeed, the record of the wicked is in sijjeen. (83:7)

كَذَّآ إِنَّ كِتَابَ الْأَبْرَارِ لَفِي عِلِّيِّينَ ١٨

No! Indeed, the record of the righteous is in ‘illiyyūn (83:18)

“Abdullah ibn Salam [narrated that] that Paradise is in the heaven and Hell is in the earth.” [Mustadrak Hakim 8698 - Sahih (agreed by al-Dhahabi)]

“Atiyyah narrated from Ibn Abbas, who said: Paradise is in the seventh heaven and Hell is in the seventh earth. This was narrated by Abu Nu‘aym. Ibn Mandah narrated from the hadith of Abu Yahya al-Qattat from Mujahid, who said: I said to Ibn ‘Abbas: Where is Paradise? He said: Above seven heavens. I said: Where is Hell? He said: Beneath seven seas, one above the other. Ibn Abi al-Dunya narrated with his isnaad from Qatadah who said: They used to say that Paradise was in the seventh heaven and that Hell was in the seventh earth.” [At-Takhwif min an-Nar of ibn Rajab al-Hanbali]

وَإِذَا الْأَرْضُ مُدَّتْ ٣ وَأَلْقَتْ مَا فِيهَا وَتَخَلَّتْ

And when the earth has been extended (i.e., stretched flat and spread out), and ejects ‘all’ its contents (i.e., treasures and dead bodies) and becomes empty (84:4)

“From its edges, it expands, just as a garment is stretched.” [Kitab al-Wajeez of al-Wahidi]

وَإِلَى الْأَرْضِ كَيْفَ سُطِحَتْ

And at the earth - how it is spread/levelled out? (88:20)

“It is said: A mountain is flattened, meaning it is level at its top. The commentators have said something similar to what we have said about this. Sa’id on the authority of Qatadah: “Meaning, it was spread out.”” [Tafseer al-Tabari]

“A surface that is level and smooth—it is all a single expanse stretching from horizon to horizon, just like rugs.” [Tafseer al-Nasafi 3/635]

It was flattened into a single, uniform surface. [Tafseer al-Mazhari]

وَالْأَرْضِ وَمَا طَحَّهَا

And [by] the earth and He who spread it (91:6)

“The meaning of His statement, “He spread it out” is: He spread it out to the right and to the left and on every side.” [Tafseer al-Tabari 24/438]

“That is, he spread it out (basataha). This is what most commentators said, like “he spread it out.” Al-Hasan, Mujahid, and others said: “He spread it out” and “he spread it out” (dahaha) are singular, meaning he spread it out on every side.” [Tafseer al-Qurtubi]

“Mujahid, Qatadah, al-Dhahhak, al-Suddi, al-Thawri, Abu Salih, and ibn Zayd said: “طَحَّاهَا” means he spread it out. This is the most famous statement, and is the opinion of most commentators. It is well-known among linguists. Al-Jawhari said: “I spread it out” (tahawtuh) is like “he rolled it out”,

(dahawtuh) meaning: I spread it out (basatahu)." [Tafseer ibn Kathir]

عَنْ ثَوْبَانَ، قَالَ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ " إِنَّ اللَّهَ زَوَى لِي الْأَرْضَ فَرَأَيْتُ مَشَارِقَهَا وَمَغَارِبَهَا وَإِنَّ أُمَّتِي سَيَبْلُغُ مُلْكُهَا مَا زُوِيَ لِي مِنْهَا..."
Thauban reported that Allah's Messenger ﷺ said: Allah drew the ends/corners of the world near one another (or, folded) for my sake. And I have seen its eastern and western ends. And the dominion of my Ummah would reach those ends which have been drawn near me... (Sahih Muslim 2889a)

عَنْ سَالِمٍ، عَنْ أَبِيهِ، قَالَ قَالَ النَّبِيُّ ﷺ " مَنْ أَخَذَ شَيْئًا مِنَ الْأَرْضِ بِغَيْرِ حَقِّهِ خُسِفَ بِهِ يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ إِلَى سَبْعِ أَرْضِينَ ".
Narrated Salim's father: The Prophet (ﷺ) said, "Any person who takes a piece of land unjustly will sink down the seven earths on the Day of Resurrection." (Sahih al-Bukhari 3196)

وَعَنْهُ قَالَ: سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ يَقُولُ: «أَيُّمَا رَجُلٍ ظَلَمَ شِبْرًا مِنَ الْأَرْضِ كَلَّفَهُ اللَّهُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ أَنْ يَحْفِرَهُ حَتَّى يَبْلُغَ آخِرَ سَبْعِ أَرْضِينَ ثُمَّ يُطَوِّفَهُ إِلَى يَوْمِ الْقِيَامَةِ حَتَّى يَقْضَى بَيْنَ النَّاسِ». رَوَاهُ أَحْمَدُ

He told of hearing Allah's Messenger ﷺ say, "If anyone wrongly takes a span of land Allah who is great and glorious will make him dig it till he gets to the end of seven earths, and then he will have it tied round his neck till the day of resurrection until men are judged." (Mishkat al-Masabih of al-Baghawi 2960)

STILLNESS

وَإِذْ قَالُوا اللَّهُمَّ إِنْ كَانَ هَذَا هُوَ الْحَقُّ مِنْ عِنْدِكَ فَأَمْطِرْ عَلَيْنَا حِجَارَةً مِّنَ السَّمَاءِ أَوْ ائْتِنَا بِعَذَابٍ أَلِيمٍ

And [remember] when they said, "O Allāh, if this should be the truth from You, then rain down upon us stones from the sky or bring us a painful punishment." (8:32)

"The reasoning behind using these five verses (26:187, 17:92, 34:9, 52:44) as evidence for the earth's stability and stillness is that Allah made the earth a center for weights (mass) and a place of settlement for what descends from the sky. So if the sky were to fall, it would fall upon the earth; and if something were to fall from it, it would not settle except upon the earth. But if the earth were moving and rotating around the sun, as claimed by the modern astronomers, then the sun would be the center and place of settlement for weights – and this is denial of the Qur'an." [Al-Mawrid al-Zalaal of Abdullah al-Durwaish, p. 261]

وَهُوَ الَّذِي مَدَّ الْأَرْضَ وَجَعَلَ فِيهَا رُوسَى وَأَنْهَارًا

And it is He who spread the earth and placed therein firmly set mountains and rivers... (13:3)

"Meaning: He spread the earth in length and width "And He placed therein firm mountains, meaning: fixed mountains; the singular is raasiyah, because the earth is fixed by it. It is established, and fixing is stability." [Tafseer al-Qurtubi 12/8]

وَأَلْقَى فِي الْأَرْضِ رَوْسَى أَنْ تَمِيدَ بِكُمْ وَأَنْهَارًا وَسُبُلًا لَّعَلَّكُمْ تَهْتَدُونَ

And He has cast into the earth firmly set mountains, lest it shift with you, and [made] rivers and roads, that you may be guided. (16:15)

"Meaning: stable mountains – "lest it should shift with them" – meaning: so that it would not shift with them, and would not move, allowing settlement upon it... And al-mayyid means: movement and rotation. It is said: "maada ra'suh" – meaning: his head turned or spun. [Tafseer al-Qurtubi 11/285]

"Al-mayyid: moving and rotating, meaning: so that it does not move and rotate with them, or due to dislike of that." [Fath al-Qadeer 405/3]

"It is disliked that it shake. It is said: a man is swayed, swaying, if he is turned around. [Kitab Ma'ani al-Quran of al-Zajjaj]

وَجَعَلْنَا فِي الْأَرْضِ رَوَاسِيَ أَنْ تَمِيدَ بِهِمْ وَجَعَلْنَا فِيهَا فِجَاجًا سُبُلًا لَّعَلَّهُمْ يَهْتَدُونَ

And We placed within the earth firmly set mountains, lest it should shift with them, and We made therein [mountain] passes [as] roads that they might be guided. (21:31)

أَمْ مَنْ جَعَلَ الْأَرْضَ قَرَارًا وَجَعَلَ خِلَالَهَا أَنْهَارًا وَجَعَلَ لَهَا رَوَاسِيَ وَجَعَلَ بَيْنَ الْبَحْرَيْنِ حَاجِزًا ۗ أَعْلَاهُ مَعَ اللَّهِ ۚ بَلْ أَكْثَرُهُمْ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ

Is He [not best] who made the earth a stable ground and placed within it rivers and made for it firmly set mountains and placed between the two seas a barrier? Is there a deity with Allāh? [No], but most of them do not know (27:61)

"That is, a landmass that is still and stable, that does not shake, move, or tremble with its inhabitants. If it were thus, life and existence would not be pleasant for it. Rather, He made it, by His grace and mercy, a stable, rugged resting place, that neither shakes nor moves." [Tafseer ibn Kathir 3/371]

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ أَنْ تَقُومَ السَّمَاءُ وَالْأَرْضُ بِأَمْرِهِ ۚ ثُمَّ إِذَا دَعَاكُمْ دَعْوَةً مِّنَ الْأَرْضِ إِذَا أَنْتُمْ تَخْرُجُونَ

And of His signs is that the heaven and earth stand (fast) [i.e., remain] by His command. Then when He calls you with a [single] call from the earth, immediately you will come forth. (30:25)

"Ibn Mas'ud said: It is sufficient for it to move that it rotates." [Tafseer al-Tabari 22/145; Al-Muharrir al-Wajeez 4/442]

"That is, they are standing firm, by His command and His making them subservient" [Tafseer ibn Kathir]

"Qiyam can mean standing and remaining steadfast. Someone walking is told: 'Waqf li,' meaning: 'Remain in your place until I come to you.' Similarly, 'Qum li,' meaning: 'Stop for me.' This is how they interpreted the words of Allah: (And when darkness descends upon them, they stand up). Linguists and commentators said: "They stood here means: they stopped and remained in their place, neither advancing nor lagging behind." [Lisan al-'Arab of ibn Mandhur 12/497]

خَلَقَ السَّمٰوٰتِ بِغَيْرِ عَمَدٍ تَّرَوْنَہَا ۗ وَالْقٰی ۚ فِی الْاَرْضِ رَوٰسِیْۤ اَنْ تَمِیْدَ بِكُمْ وَبَثَّ فِیْہَا مِنْ كُلِّ دَآبَّۃٍ ۚ وَاَنْزَلْنَا مِنْ السَّمَآءِ مَآءً فَانۡبَتْنَا فِیْہَا مِنْ كُلِّ رَوْحٍ کَرِیۡمٍ

He created the heavens without pillars that you see and has cast into the earth firmly set mountains, lest it should shift with you, and dispersed therein from every creature. And We sent down rain from the sky and made grow therein [plants] of every noble kind. (31:10)

اِنَّ اللّٰهَ یُمْسِكُ السَّمٰوٰتِ وَالْاَرْضَ اَنْ تَرُوۡلَا ۚ وَلَیۡنَ زَالَتَا ۤاِنْ اَمْسَکَہُمَا مِنْ اَحَدٍ ۚ مِّنۢ بَعْدِہٖۤ اِنَّہٗ کَانَ خَلِیۡمًا غَفُوۡرًا

Indeed, Allāh holds the heavens and the earth, lest they cease/deviate/move away. And if they

should cease, no one could hold/grasp them [in place] after Him. Indeed, He is Forbearing and Forgiving. (35:41)

“Sa’id ibn Mansur, Abd ibn Humayd, ibn Jareer (al-Tabari), and ibn Al-Mundhir (all) narrated from Shaqiq who said: “It was said to ibn Mas’ud: ‘Verily Ka’b says: Verily the earth spins around a pole, just like the pole of a hand-mill, in a pillar which is on the shoulder of an angel.’ So he said: ‘Ka’b has lied. Verily Allah says: “Verily Allah grasps the heavens and the earth lest they move away.” And it is enough moving away for them if they were to spin.”

Ibn Abi Shaybah, ‘Abd ibn Humayd, ibn al-Mundhir, ibn Abi Hatim and Abu al-Shaykh by way of Abu Malik, (all) narrated from ibn Abbas who said: “The earth is upon a whale, and the chain is in the ear of the whale, and the whale is in the Hand of Allah the Exalted, and that is His words, (the verse).”
[Al-Durr al-Manthur of al-Suyuti]

هُوَ الَّذِي جَعَلَ لَكُمُ الْأَرْضَ ذَلُولًا فَامْشُوا فِي مَنَاكِبِهَا وَكُلُوا مِن رِّزْقِهِ وَإِلَيْهِ النُّشُورُ ١٥ ءَأَمِنْتُمْ مِّنْ فِي السَّمَاءِ أَن يَخْسِفَ بِكُمُ الْأَرْضَ فَإِذَا هِيَ تَمُورُ

It is He who made the earth tame (i.e., stable or smoothed out) for you - so walk among its slopes and eat of His provision - and to Him is the resurrection. Do you feel secure that He who is in heaven would not cause the earth to swallow you and suddenly it would sway (in a circular motion, as in an earthquake)? (67:15-16)

“That is, it will tremble and move, contrary to its former state of stillness.” [Fath al-Qadeer 5/262]

“If this is known, then the verse of Surah al-Mulk indicates that the Earth is a stationary landmass, and does not rotate, coming and going. For this reason, Allah bestowed His favor upon His servants by making it subservient to them, and warned them of His punishment by causing the Earth to swallow them up and make it sway with them. If the matter were as the modern astronomers and those who imitate them from the modernists claim, then the Earth would always sway as the stars, clouds, and wind sway, and there would be no benefit in frightening them with its sway.” [Al-Mawrid al-Zalaal of Abdullah al-Durwaish, p. 260]

أَلَمْ نَجْعَلِ الْأَرْضَ مِهْدًا ۖ ۝ وَالْجِبَالَ أَوْتَادًا ۚ

Have We not made the earth a resting place? And the mountains as stakes/pegs (to stabilize the land and balance the earth)? (78:7)

“Meaning: paved for creation, submissive to them, stable and firm. ‘And the mountains as pegs’ means: He made them pegs for it; He anchored them with them, made them firm and established them, until they became still and did not shake with those on them.” [Tafseer ibn Kathir 4/463]

الأرض ثابتة وقرار وليست متحركة ولا تدور

“The Earth is fixed and stable, not moving or rotating.” [Miftaah Daar al-Sa’adah wa Manshur Wilayah al-Ilm wal-Iradah of ibn al-Qayyim 1/217]

الْأَرْضُ يُحِيطُ الْمَاءُ بِأَكْثَرِهَا وَالْهَوَاءُ يُحِيطُ بِالْمَاءِ وَالْأَرْضُ وَاللَّهُ تَعَالَى بَسَطَ الْأَرْضَ لِلْأَنَامِ وَأَرْسَاهَا بِالْجِبَالِ؛ لِئَلَّا تَمِيدَ كَمَا تَرُسى السَّوْفِينَةُ بِالْأَجْسَامِ الثَّقِيلَةِ إِذَا كَثُرَتْ أَمْوَاجُ الْبَحْرِ

"The Earth is surrounded by water, and the air surrounds the water and the Earth. Allah spread out the Earth for mankind and fixed it with mountains, so that it does not shake, as a ship anchors with heavy objects when the waves of the sea increase." [Majnu' al-Fatawa 6/596]

"Some of those present asked me about the ruling on someone who says that the earth moves and travels. I answered that he is a kafir. He said to me, 'How do you declare him a kafir?' I told him, 'Because he denied Allah in his news, because Allah has informed in several verses that it does not move, and it is impossible for Allah to lie or anything similar.'" [Al-Masa'il al-Kafiyyah fi Bayan Wujud Sidq Khabr Rabb al-Bariyyah of Muhammad ibn Yusuf al-Kafi al-Tunsi]

THE FIRMAMENT

الَّذِي جَعَلَ لَكُمُ الْأَرْضَ فِرَاشًا وَالسَّمَاءَ بِنَاءً

[He] who made for you the earth a bed [spread out] and the sky a ceiling/canopy (2:22)

"Ibn Mas'ud and people from the Companions, regarding His words [the verse]: He said: '... And the heaven is the ceiling.' He said: He built the heaven upon the earth in the shape of a dome, and it is the roof of the earth." [Al-Durr al-Manthur]

"And the sky is a building; it was mentioned in the interpretation as a ceiling, and everything that rises above a man is a roof. Allah informed them to what is [required] in spreading out the earth and its expansion and building the sky." [Al-Tayseer fi Ilm al-Tafseer of al-Qushayri, p. 462]

هُوَ الَّذِي خَلَقَ لَكُمْ مَا فِي الْأَرْضِ جَمِيعًا ثُمَّ أَسْتَوَىٰ إِلَى السَّمَاءِ فَسَوَّاهُنَّ سَبْعَ سَمَوَاتٍ وَهُوَ بِكُلِّ شَيْءٍ عَلِيمٌ

It is He who created for you all of that which is on the earth. Then He directed Himself to the heaven, [His being above all creation], and made them seven heavens, and He is Knowing of all things. (2:29)

عَنِ الْعَبَّاسِ بْنِ عَبْدِ الْمُطَّلِبِ، قَالَ: كُنَّا عِنْدَ النَّبِيِّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ فَقَالَ: هَلْ تَدْرُونَ كَمَا بَيْنَ السَّمَاءِ وَالْأَرْضِ؟ قُلْنَا: اللَّهُ وَرَسُولُهُ أَعْلَمُ قَالَ: بَيْنَهُمَا مَسِيرَةُ خَمْسِمِائَةِ سَنَةٍ، وَمِنْ كُلِّ سَمَاءٍ إِلَى سَمَاءٍ مَسِيرَةُ خَمْسِمِائَةِ سَنَةٍ، وَكَتِفُ كُلِّ سَمَاءٍ خَمْسِمِائَةِ سَنَةٍ، وَفَوْقَ السَّمَاءِ السَّابِعَةِ بَحْرٌ، بَيْنَ أَعْلَاهُ وَأَسْفَلِهِ كَمَا بَيْنَ السَّمَاءِ وَالْأَرْضِ، ثُمَّ فَوْقَ ذَلِكَ ثَمَانِيَةُ أَوْ عَالٍ، بَيْنَ رُكْبَتَيْهِ وَأُظْلَافِهِنَّ كَمَا بَيْنَ السَّمَاءِ وَالْأَرْضِ، ثُمَّ فَوْقَ ذَلِكَ الْعَرْشُ بَيْنَ أَسْفَلِهِ وَأَعْلَاهُ كَمَا بَيْنَ السَّمَاءِ وَالْأَرْضِ، وَاللَّهُ سُبْحَانَهُ وَتَعَالَىٰ فَوْقَ ذَلِكَ، وَلَيْسَ يَخْفَىٰ عَلَيْهِ مِنْ أَعْمَالِ بَنِي آدَمَ شَيْءٌ

From Abbas: "We were with the Prophet ﷺ when he said: 'Do you know how far there is between the heaven and the earth?' We said: 'Allah and His Messenger ﷺ know best.' He said: 'Between them is (the travel distance of) five hundred years. And from every heaven to (the next) heaven there is five hundred years. And the thickness of every heaven is five hundred years. And above the seventh heaven is a sea. Between the highest of it and the lowest of it is the same distance as between the heaven and earth. And Allah – subhanahu wa ta'ala – is above (all) this. And none of the deeds of the son of Adam are hidden for him.'

(Related by: Imam Ahmad, Abu Dawud, al-Hakim - Sahih, al-Tirmidhi - Hasan, ibn Majah, al-Jawzaqani in *Al-Abatil* (82) - Sahih, al-Darimi, al-Lalaka'i in *as-Sunnah*, al-Bayhaqi in *al-Asma wal-Sifat*, ibn Abi al-Dunya in *Kitab al-Matar*, ibn Abi Asim in *as-Sunnah*, Abu Ya'la, ibn Khuzaymah in *al-Tawhid*, ibn Abi Hatim, Abu Ahmad, al-Tabarani in *al-Kabeer*, Abu al-Shaykh in *al-'Adhamah*)

"Mujahid commented on Allah's statement, that "Allah created the earth before heaven, and when He created the earth, smoke burst out of it. This is why Allah said [the verse] and made them seven heavens, meaning one above the other, while the 'seven earths' means one below the other." This Ayah testifies to the fact that the earth was created before heaven, as Allah has indicated in the Ayat in Surah As-Sajdah. Sahih al-Bukhari records that when ibn Abbas was questioned about this matter, he said that the earth was created before heaven, and the earth was spread out only after the creation of the heaven. Several Tafseer scholars of old and recent times also said similarly." [Tafseer ibn Kathir]

إِنَّ الَّذِينَ كَذَّبُوا بِآيَاتِنَا وَاسْتَكْبَرُوا عَنْهَا لَا تُفَتَّحُ لَهُمْ أَبْوَابُ السَّمَاءِ

Indeed, those who deny Our verses and are arrogant toward them - the gates of Heaven will not be opened for them (7:40)

وَهُوَ الَّذِي خَلَقَ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ فِي سِتَّةِ أَيَّامٍ وَكَانَ عَرْشُهُ عَلَى الْمَاءِ لِيَبْلُوَكُمْ أَيُّكُمْ أَحْسَنُ عَمَلًا وَلَئِنَّ

And it is He who created the heavens and the earth in six days - and His Throne had been upon water - that He might test you as to which of you is best in deed. (11:7)

Al-Rabi' ibn Anas said, "And His Throne was over the water," so when He created the heavens and the earth, He divided that water into two parts, and He placed one half under the Throne, which is the burning sea. [Tafseer ibn Kathir]

اللَّهُ الَّذِي رَفَعَ السَّمَوَاتِ بِغَيْرِ عَمَدٍ تَرَوْنَهَا ثُمَّ أَسْتَوَىٰ عَلَى الْعَرْشِ وَسَخَّرَ الشَّمْسَ وَالْقَمَرَ كُلٌّ يَجْرِي لِأَجَلٍ مُّسَمًّى يُدَبِّرُ الْأَمْرَ يُفَصِّلُ الْآيَاتِ لَعَلَّكُمْ بِلِقَاءِ رَبِّكُمْ تُوقِنُونَ ٢

It is Allah who erected the heavens without pillars that you [can] see; then He established Himself above the Throne and made subject the sun and the moon, each running/orbiting [its course] for a specified term. He arranges [each] matter; He details the signs that you may, of the meeting with your Lord, be certain. (13:2)

"Meaning, 'there are pillars, but you cannot see them,' according to ibn Abbas, Mujahid, al-Hasan, Qatadah, and several other scholars. Iyas bin Mu`awiyah said, "The heaven is like a dome over the earth," meaning, without pillars. Similar was reported from Qatadah, and this meaning is better for this part of the Ayah, especially since Allah said in another ayah, "He withholds the heaven from falling on the earth except by His permission." (22:65) [Tafseer ibn Kathir]

وَلَوْ فَتَحْنَا عَلَيْهِم بَابًا مِّنَ السَّمَاءِ فَظَلُّوا فِيهِ يَعْرُجُونَ ١٤ لَقَالُوا إِنَّمَا سُكَّرَتْ أَبْصَارُنَا بَلْ نَحْنُ قَوْمٌ مَّسْحُورُونَ ١٥ وَلَقَدْ جَعَلْنَا فِي السَّمَاءِ بُرُوجًا وَرَازِبِينَهَا لِلنَّظِيرِينَ ١٦ وَحَفَظْنَاهَا مِنْ كُلِّ شَيْطَانٍ رَّجِيمٍ ١٧

And [even] if We opened to them a gate from the heaven and they continued therein to ascend, They would say, "Our eyes have only been dazzled. Rather, we are a people affected by magic."

And We have placed within the heaven great stars/constellations/mansions of the stars and have beautified it for the observers. And We protected it from every accursed devil (15:14-17)

أَوْ تُسْقِطَ السَّمَاءَ كَمَا زَعَمْتَ عَلَيْنَا كِسْفًا أَوْ تَأْتِيَ بَالَهُ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ قِيَالًا

Or you make the heaven fall upon us in fragments as you have claimed or you bring Allah and the angels before [us] (17:92)

تَكَادُ السَّمَوَاتُ يَتَّقَطُّنَ مِنْهُ وَتَشَقُّ الْأَرْضُ وَتَخِرُّ الْجِبَالُ هَدًّا

The heavens almost rupture/tear therefrom and the earth splits open and the mountains collapse in devastation. (19:90)

أَوَلَمْ يَرِ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا أَنَّ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ كَانَتَا رَتْقًا فَفَتَقْنَاهُمَا ۖ وَجَعَلْنَا مِنَ الْمَاءِ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ حَيٍّ أَفَلَا يُؤْمِنُونَ

Have those who disbelieved not considered that the heavens and the earth were a joined entity (or one piece), and then We separated them and made from water every living thing? Then will they not believe? (21:30)

Ibn Abi Shaybah, Abd ibn Humayd, ibn al-Mundhir, ibn Abi Hatim, Abu al-Shaykh (all) narrated from Mujahid regarding (the verse). He said: "From the earth, He cut (or split) six earths more along with it, and these are the seven earths which are below one another. And from the heaven (He split or cut) six heavens along with it, and those are the seven heavens which are above one another. And the earth and the heaven did not (formerly) touch one another." [al-Durr al-Manthur]

وَجَعَلْنَا السَّمَاءَ سَقْفًا مَحْفُوظًا وَهُمْ عَنْ آيَاتِهَا مُعْرِضُونَ

And We made the sky a protected/withheld ceiling/roof/canopy, but they, from its signs, are turning away. (21:32)

"Meaning, covering the earth like a dome above it. This is like the Ayah (51:47), (91:5), [and] (50:6). The building and making described here refers to the raising of the dome, as when the Messenger of Allah said, "Islam is built on five," i.e., five pillars, which can only refer to a tent as familiar among the Arabs." [Tafseer ibn Kathir]

يَوْمَ نَطْوِي السَّمَاءَ كَطَيِّ السِّجِلِّ لِلْكُتُبِ ۚ كَمَا بَدَأْنَا أَوَّلَ خَلْقٍ نُعِيدُهُ ۚ وَعْدًا عَلَيْنَا ۚ إِنَّا كُنَّا فَاعِلِينَ

The Day when We will fold/roll up the heaven like the folding of a [written] sheet for the records. As We began the first creation, We will repeat it. [That is] a promise binding upon Us. Indeed, We will do it. (21:104)

أَلَمْ تَرَ أَنَّ اللَّهَ سَخَّرَ لَكُم مَّا فِي الْأَرْضِ وَالْفُلُكَ تَجْرَى فِي الْبَحْرِ بِأَمْرٍ ۖ وَيُسَبِّحُ السَّمَاءَ أَنْ تَقَعَ عَلَى الْأَرْضِ إِلَّا بِإِذْنِهِ ۚ إِنَّ اللَّهَ بِالنَّاسِ لَرَءُوفٌ رَحِيمٌ

Do you not see that Allah has subjected to you whatever is on the earth and the ships which run through the sea by His command? And He restrains the sky from falling upon the earth, unless by His permission. Indeed Allah, to the people, is Kind and Merciful. (22:65)

وَلَقَدْ خَلَقْنَا فَوْقَكُمْ سَبْعَ طَرَائِقَ وَمَا كُنَّا عَنِ الْخَلْقِ غَافِلِينَ

And We have created above you seven layered (or levels of) heavens, and never have We been of [Our] creation unaware. (23:17)

وَيَوْمَ تَشْقُقُ السَّمَاءُ بِالسَّعْمِ وَتُنَزَّلُ الْمَلَائِكَةُ تَنْزِيلًا

And [mention] the Day when the heaven will split open with [emerging] clouds (within which are the angels), and the angels will be sent down in successive descent. (25:25)

فَأَسْقِطْ عَلَيْنَا كِسْفًا مِّنَ السَّمَاءِ إِن كُنتَ مِنَ الصَّادِقِينَ

Then make fragments of the heaven fall upon us, if you are of the truthful. (26:187)

أَفَلَمْ يَرَوْا إِلَى مَا بَيْنَ أَيْدِيهِمْ وَمَا خَلْفَهُمْ مِّنَ السَّمَاءِ وَالْأَرْضِ ۚ إِن نَّشَاءُ نَخْسِفُ بِهِمُ الْأَرْضَ أَوْ نُسْقِطُ عَلَيْهِمْ كِسْفًا مِّنَ السَّمَاءِ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَلِكَ لَآيَةً لِّكُلِّ عَبْدٍ مُّنِيبٍ

Then, do they not look at what is before them and what is behind them of the heaven and earth? If We should will, We could cause the earth to swallow them or [could] let fall upon them fragments from the sky. Indeed in that is a sign for every servant turning back [to Allah]. (34:9)

وَمَا قَدَرُوا اللَّهَ حَقَّ قَدْرِهِ وَالْأَرْضُ جَمِيعًا قَبْضَتُهُ يَوْمَ الْقِيَمَةِ وَالسَّمَوَاتُ مَطْوِيَّاتٌ بِّمِيزَةٍ ۚ سُبْحَنَهُ وَتَعَالَى عَمَّا يُشْرِكُونَ

And they did not estimate Allah His true estimate, while the earth entirely will be [within] His

grip (literally, "no more than a handful of His") on the Day of Resurrection, and the heavens will be folded/rolled up in His right hand. Exalted is He and high above what they associate with Him. (39:67)

My father [i.e. Imam Ahmad] narrated to me... from ibn Mas'ud who said that a rabbi came to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ and said: "O Muhammad! Verily Allah on the Day of Judgment will put the heavens upon one Finger, and the earth upon one Finger, and the mountains and the trees upon one Finger, and the water and the soil upon one Finger and the rest of the creation upon one Finger. Then He will shake them all and say: 'I am the King.'" So the Prophet ﷺ laughed until his molar teeth became visible. And he recited [the verse]. (Kitab al-Sunnah of Abdullah ibn Imam Ahmad with multiple isnaad)

اللَّهُ الَّذِي جَعَلَ لَكُمُ الْأَرْضَ قَرَارًا وَالسَّمَاءَ بِنَاءً وَصَوَّرَكُمْ فَأَحْسَنَ صُوَرَكُمْ وَرَزَقَكُم مِّنَ الطَّيِّبَاتِ ۚ ذَلِكُمْ اللَّهُ رَبُّ الْعَالَمِينَ
It is Allah who made for you the earth a place of settlement and the sky a structure/canopy [i.e., ceiling] and formed you and perfected your forms and provided you with good things. That is Allah, your Lord; then blessed is Allāh, Lord of the worlds. (40:64)

ثُمَّ أَسْتَوَىٰ إِلَى السَّمَاءِ وَهِيَ دُخَانٌ فَقَالَ لَهَا وَلِلْأَرْضِ ائْتِيَا طَوْعًا أَوْ كَرْهًا قَالَتَا أَتَيْنَا طَائِعِينَ ۝۱۱ فَفَضَّلَهُنَّ سَبْعَ سَمَوَاتٍ فِي يَوْمَيْنِ وَأَوْحَىٰ فِي كُلِّ سَمَاءٍ أَمْرَهَا ۚ وَزَيَّنَّا السَّمَاءَ الدُّنْيَا بِمَصَابِيحَ وَحِفْظًا ۚ ذَٰلِكَ تَقْدِيرُ الْعَزِيزِ الْعَلِيمِ ۝۱۲

Then He directed Himself to the heaven while it was smoke and said to it and to the earth, "Come [into being], willingly or by compulsion." They said, "We have come willingly." And He completed them as seven heavens within two days and inspired [i.e., made known] in each heaven its command. And We adorned the nearest heaven with lamps [i.e., stars, for beauty] and as protection. That is the determination of the Exalted in Might, the Knowing. (41:11-12)

تَكَادُ السَّمَوَاتُ يَتَّقَطُّنَ مِن فَوْقِهِنَّ ۚ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ يُسَبِّحُونَ بِحَمْدِ رَبِّهِمْ وَيَسْتَغْفِرُونَ لِمَن فِي الْأَرْضِ ۚ إِنَّ اللَّهَ هُوَ الْغَفُورُ الرَّحِيمُ
The heavens almost break from above them (i.e., from the grandeur of Allah above them), and the angels exalt [Allah] with praise of their Lord and ask forgiveness for those on earth. Unquestionably, it is Allah who is the Forgiving, the Merciful. (42:5)

أَفَلَمْ يَنْظُرُوا إِلَى السَّمَاءِ فَوْقَهُمْ كَيْفَ بَنَيْنَاهَا وَزَيَّنَّاهَا وَمَا لَهَا مِنْ فُرُوجٍ
Have they not looked at the heaven above them - how We structured/constructed it and adorned it and [how] it has no rifts? (50:7)

وَالسَّمَاءَ بَنَيْنَاهَا بِأَيْدٍ وَإِنَّا لَمُوسِعُونَ
And the heaven We constructed with strength (literally, "hands"), and indeed, We are [its] expander (or, We it is Who make the vast extent). (51:47)

(We constructed the heaven.) meaning, 'We made it as a high roof, protected from falling...' [It] means, 'We made it vast and We brought its roof higher without pillars to support it, and thus it is hanging independently.' [Tafseer ibn Kathir]

وَالسَّفِّ الْمَرْفُوعِ
And [by] the ceiling/canopy/roof [i.e., heaven] raised high (52:5)

وَإِنْ يَرَوْا كِسْفًا مِّنَ السَّمَاءِ سَاقِطًا يَقُولُوا سَحَابٌ مَّرْكُومٌ
And if they were to see a fragment of the heaven falling, they would say, "[It is merely] a heap of clouds." (52:44)

فَفَتَحْنَا أَبْوَابَ السَّمَاءِ بِمَاءٍ مُنْهَمِرٍ

Then We opened the gates of the heaven with rain pouring down (54:11)

وَالسَّمَاءَ رَفَعَهَا وَوَضَعَ الْمِيزَانَ

And the heaven He raised and imposed the balance/measure (55:7)

يَا مَعْشَرَ الْجِنِّ وَالْإِنسِ إِنِ اسْتَطَعْتُمْ أَنْ تَنْفُذُوا مِنْ أَقْطَارِ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ فَانْفُذُوا ۚ لَا تَنْفُذُونَ إِلَّا بِسُلْطَانٍ

O company of jinn and mankind, if you are able to pass beyond/penetrate the regions/realms of the heavens and the earth, then pass. You will not pass except by authority [from Allah]. (55:33)

فَإِذَا انشَقَّتِ السَّمَاءُ فَكَانَتْ وَرْدَةً كَالدِّهَانِ

And when the heaven is split open and becomes rose-colored like oil (55:37)

اللَّهُ الَّذِي خَلَقَ سَبْعَ سَمَوَاتٍ وَمِنَ الْأَرْضِ مِثْلَهُنَّ يَتَنَزَّلُ الْأَمْرُ بَيْنَهُنَّ لِتَعْلَمُوا أَنَّ اللَّهَ عَلَىٰ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدِيرٌ وَأَنَّ اللَّهَ قَدْ أَحَاطَ بِكُلِّ شَيْءٍ عِلْمًا

It is Allah who has created seven heavens and of the earth, the like of them. [His] command descends among them so you may know that Allah is over all things competent and that Allah has encompassed all things in knowledge. (65:12)

“Ibn Mas‘ud said: The distance between the lowest heaven and the next one is the distance of five hundred years’ travel, and the distance between each heaven and the next is the distance of five hundred years’ travel.” [Al-Mu‘jam al-Kabeer of At-Tabarani 8987 - Hasan]

الَّذِي خَلَقَ سَبْعَ سَمَوَاتٍ طِبَاقًا ۚ مَا تَرَىٰ فِي خَلْقِ الرَّحْمَنِ مِن تَفَوتٍ ۚ فَارْجِعِ الْبَصَرَ هَلْ تَرَىٰ مِن فُتُورٍ

[And] who created seven heavens in layers (i.e., one covering or fitting over the other). You do not see in the creation of the Most Merciful any inconsistency. So return [your] vision [to the sky]; do you see any breaks/rifts/flaws? (67:3)

Muslims believe that the sky is a massive structure and a roof for what is beneath it, with no visible pillars. Allah described it in His Noble Book in a manner that demonstrates its utmost perfection, such as His statement [the verse]. So whoever says and believes that it is an atmosphere and space (جو فضاء), not a structure, and persists in this [belief], has disbelieved by rejecting Allah in His statement, {والسما بناء} and in His statement, {وجعلنا السماء سقفا محفوظا} and in His statement, {والسما بناها} and in His statement {أنتم أشد} أنتم أشد. There are other verses indicating that it is a solid structure. [Al-Masa’il al-Kafiyyah of Muhammad ibn Yusuf al-Kafi al-Tunsi]

أَلَمْ تَرَ أَنَّ اللَّهَ خَلَقَ سَبْعَ سَمَوَاتٍ طِبَاقًا

Do you not consider how Allah has created seven heavens in layers? (71:15)

السَّمَاءُ مُنْفَطِرٌ بِهِ ۚ كَانَ وَعْدُهُ مَفْعُولًا

The heaven will break/split apart therefrom; ever is His promise fulfilled. (73:18)

وَإِذَا السَّمَاءُ فُرِجَتْ

And when the heaven is opened (or, is torn apart) (77:9)

وَبَنَيْنَا فَوْقَكُمْ سَبْعًا شَدِيدًا

And constructed above you seven strong (Editor's note: also translated as solid) [heavens]. (78:12)

وَفُتِحَتِ السَّمَاءُ فَكَانَتْ أَبْوَابًا

And the heaven is opened and will become gateways. (78:19)

ءَأَنْتُمْ أَشَدُّ خُلُقًا أَمْ السَّمَاءُ بَنَاهَا ۚ ٢٧ رَفَعَ سَمَكَهَا فَسَوَّيَهَا ٢٨ وَأَغْطَشَ لَيْلَهَا وَأَخْرَجَ ضُحَاهَا ٢٩

Are you a more difficult creation or is the heaven? He [i.e., Allah] constructed it. He raised its ceiling and proportioned it. And He darkened its night and extracted its brightness (or, brought forth its daylight/morn). (79:27-29)

إِذَا السَّمَاءُ انْفَطَرَتْ

When the heaven splits open/breaks apart (82:1)

إِذَا السَّمَاءُ انشَقَّتْ

When the sky has split/burst [open] (84:1)

وَالِى السَّمَاءِ كَيْفَ رُفِعَتْ

And at the sky - how it is raised? (88:18)

"The commentators of the Book of Allah ('Azza wa Jall) believed that the heaven is flat, based on His saying, (88:18)." [Nihayat al-Arab of Al-Nuwayri]

وَالسَّمَاءُ وَمَا بَيْنَهَا

And [by] the heaven and He who constructed it (91:5)

عَنْ أَبِي ذَرٍّ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: مَا بَيْنَ السَّمَاءِ وَالْأَرْضِ مَسِيرَةُ خَمْسِمِائَةِ عَامٍ، وَغِلْظُ كُلِّ سَمَاءٍ مَسِيرَةُ خَمْسِمِائَةِ عَامٍ، وَمَا بَيْنَ السَّمَاءِ إِلَى تَلِيهَا مَسِيرَةُ خَمْسِمِائَةِ عَامٍ كَذَلِكَ إِلَى السَّمَاءِ السَّابِعَةِ، وَالْأَرْضُ مِثْلُ ذَلِكَ، وَمَا بَيْنَ السَّمَاءِ السَّابِعَةِ إِلَى الْعَرْشِ مِثْلُ جَمِيعِ ذَلِكَ، وَلَوْ حَفَرْتُمْ الصَّاحِيحُ ثُمَّ دَلَيْتُمُوهُ لَوَجَدَ اللَّهُ ثَمَةً. يَعْني عِلْمَهُ.

Abu Dharr said: "The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: 'Between the heaven and the earth is the travel distance of five hundred years. And the thickness of every heaven is five hundred years. And what is between the heaven and the one (heaven) that comes after it is likewise the travel distance of five hundred years, until the seventh heaven. And the earths are just like this. And between the seventh heaven and the Throne is the same as all of this (added together). And if you were to dig for your companion and then lowered him into it, he would verily find Allah there.'" This means, His knowledge. (Musnad Ishaq, Musnad al-Bazzar, and from ibn Marduyah and al-Bayhaqi)

عَنْ أَبِي ذَرٍّ، قَالَ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ " إِنِّي أَرَى مَا لَا تَرَوْنَ وَأَسْمَعُ مَا لَا تَسْمَعُونَ إِنَّ السَّمَاءَ أَطَّتْ وَحَقٌّ لَهَا أَنْ تَنْبُطَ مَا فِيهَا مَوْضِعُ أَرْبَعِ أَصَابِعٍ إِلَّا وَمَلَكٌ وَاضِعٌ جَبْهَتَهُ سَاجِدًا لِلَّهِ..."

Abu Dharr narrated that the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said: "I see what you do not see, and I hear what you do not hear. The heaven is creaking and it should creak, for there is no space in it the width of four fingers but there is an angel there, prostrating to Allah..." (Sunan ibn Majah 4190 - Hasan by Darussalam)

عَنْ جُبَيْرِ بْنِ مُحَمَّدٍ بْنِ جُبَيْرٍ بْنِ مُطْعِمٍ عَنْ أَبِيهِ عَنْ جَدِّهِ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: ...وَيَحْكُ أَتَدْرِي مَا اللَّهُ إِنَّ عَرْشَهُ عَلَى سَمَوَاتِهِ لَهَكَدَا " وَقَالَ بِأَصَابِعِهِ مِثْلَ الْفُتَّةِ عَلَيْهِ " وَإِنَّهُ لَيَنْبُطُ بِهِ أَطْبِيطُ الرَّحْلَ بِالرَّكَبِ " . قَالَ ابْنُ بَشَّارٍ فِي حَدِيثِهِ " إِنَّ اللَّهَ فَوْقَ عَرْشِهِ وَعَرْشُهُ فَوْقَ سَمَوَاتِهِ " The Messenger ﷺ said: "...Do you know how great Allah is? His throne is above the heavens thus (indicating with his fingers like a dome over him), and it groans on account of Him as a saddle does because of the rider." Ibn Basharr said in his version: "Allah is above the throne, and

the throne is above the heavens." (Or, "The Throne is upon the heavens just like a dome...")
(Sahih Sunan Abu Dawud 4726, Sahih by ibn Khuzaymah, ibn Mandah, al-Baghawi, ibn Taymiyyah, ibn Qayyim, etc.)

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ - رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ - عَنِ النَّبِيِّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ قَالَ " يَقْبِضُ اللَّهُ الْأَرْضَ، وَيَطْوِي السَّمَاءَ بِيَمِينِهِ، ثُمَّ يَقُولُ أَنَا الْمَلِكُ أَيْنَ مُلُوكُ الْأَرْضِ " Narrated Abu Huraira: The Prophet ﷺ said, "Allah will take the whole earth (in His Hand) and will roll up the Heaven in His right Hand, and then He will say, "I am King! Where are the kings of the earth?" (Sahih al-Bukhari 6519)

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قَالَ إِبْرَاهِيمُ فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ يَأْتِي بِالشَّمْسِ مِنَ الْمَشْرِقِ فَأْتِ بِهَا مِنَ الْمَغْرِبِ فَبُهِتَ الَّذِي كَفَرَ ۗ وَاللَّهُ لَا يَهْدِي الْقَوْمَ الظَّالِمِينَ
Ibrahim said, "Indeed, Allah brings up the sun from the east, so bring it up from the west." So the disbeliever was overwhelmed [by astonishment], and Allah does not guide the wrongdoing people. (2:258)

"And this verse is among the clearest proofs of the movement of the sun and its orbit around the Earth, and that Allah the Almighty has subjected it to come from the East every day and go towards the West. If it were stationary and did not move from its place, as the proponents of modern astronomy claim, then the mention of bringing it from the East would be absurd, meaningless, and of no benefit in mentioning it.

And Ibrahim (peace be upon him) should have said to his opponent: 'Allah brings the Earth from the West, so bring it from the East.'

"So may Allah fight against the proponents of modern astronomy who have twisted the truth and reversed the matter without proof, but merely with conjecture and speculation. And upon them applies the saying of Allah the Almighty concerning their likes among the guessers: (And they have no knowledge thereof. They follow but a guess, and lo! a guess can never take the place of the truth.) (53:28)."

[Al-Sawa'iq al-Shadeedah of al-Turwajiri]

فَالِقُ الْإِصْبَاحِ وَجَعَلَ اللَّيْلَ سَكَنًا وَالشَّمْسَ وَالْقَمَرَ حُسْبَانًا ۚ ذَلِكَ تَقْدِيرُ الْعَزِيزِ الْعَلِيمِ

[He is] the cleaver of daybreak and has made the night for rest and the sun and moon for calculation. [Or "according to calculation," referring to their precise movement.] That is the determination/measure of the Exalted in Might, the Knowing. (6:96)

إِنَّ رَبَّكُمُ اللَّهُ الَّذِي خَلَقَ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ فِي سِتَّةِ أَيَّامٍ ثُمَّ اسْتَوَىٰ عَلَى الْعَرْشِ يُغْشَىٰ اللَّيْلَ النَّهَارَ يَطْلُبُهُ حَثِيثًا وَالشَّمْسَ وَالْقَمَرَ وَالنُّجُومَ مُسَخَّرَاتٍ بِأَمْرِهِ ۗ أَلَا لَهُ الْخَلْقُ وَالْأَمْرُ ۗ تَبَارَكَ اللَّهُ رَبُّ الْعَالَمِينَ

Indeed, your Lord is Allah, who created the heavens and earth in six days and then established Himself above the Throne. He covers/overlaps the night with the day, [another night] chasing it rapidly; and [He created] the sun, the moon, and the stars, subjected by His command.

Unquestionably, His is the creation and the command; blessed is Allah, Lord of the worlds.

(7:54)

هُوَ الَّذِي جَعَلَ الشَّمْسَ ضِيَاءً وَالْقَمَرَ نُورًا وَقَدَرَهُ مَنَازِلَ لِتَعْلَمُوا عَدَدَ السِّنِينَ وَالْحِسَابَ ۚ مَا خَلَقَ اللَّهُ ذَلِكَ إِلَّا بِالْحَقِّ ۚ يُفَصِّلُ الْآيَاتِ لِقَوْمٍ يَعْلَمُونَ

It is He who made the sun a shining light and the moon a light and determined for it phases - that you may know the number of years and account [of time]. Allah has not created this except in truth. He details the signs for a people who know. (10:5)

"The words dhiyaa, noor, and so on refer to something that produces light by itself, such as the sun and moon, and such as fire. Allah, may He be exalted, says [10:5 and 78:13]. Allah, may He be glorified, calls

the sun siraa (lamp) and dhiyaa (light) because in addition to illuminating and shining, it produces heat and burning. So it is more akin to fire, unlike the moon, which illuminates without heat. Hence He says: [10:5]. The point here is that the words dhiyaa, noor, and so on refer to something that shines and illuminates by itself, such as the sun, moon and fire. [Al-Jawaab al-Sahih of ibn Taymiyyah 4/368]

“The difference between dhiyaa and noor: they are synonymous in linguistic terms.” [Mu’jam al-Furooq al-Lughawiyyah of Abu Hilal al-Askari p. 332]

اللَّهُ الَّذِي رَفَعَ السَّمَوَاتِ بِغَيْرِ عَمَدٍ تَرَوْنَهَا ثُمَّ أَسْتَوَىٰ عَلَى الْعَرْشِ وَسَخَّرَ الشَّمْسَ وَالْقَمَرَ كُلٌّ يَجْرِي لِأَجَلٍ مُّسَمًّى يُدَبِّرُ الْأَمْرَ يُفَصِّلُ الْآيَاتِ لَعَلَّكُمْ بِلِقَاءِ رَبِّكُمْ تُوقِنُونَ

It is Allah who erected the heavens without pillars that you [can] see; then He established Himself above the Throne and made subject the sun and the moon, each running [its course] for a specified term. He arranges [each] matter (or, orders the course); He details the signs that you may, of the meeting with your Lord, be certain. (13:2)

وَسَخَّرَ لَكُمْ الشَّمْسَ وَالْقَمَرَ دَائِبَيْنِ وَسَخَّرَ لَكُمُ اللَّيْلَ وَالنَّهَارَ

And He subjected for you the sun and the moon, continuous [in orbit], and subjected for you the night and the day. (14:33)

وَلَقَدْ جَعَلْنَا فِي السَّمَاءِ بُرُوجًا وَزَيَّنَّاهَا لِلنَّاظِرِينَ ۖ وَحَفِظْنَاهَا مِنْ كُلِّ شَيْطَانٍ رَّجِيمٍ ۚ إِلَّا مَنْ أَسْتَرَقَ السَّمْعَ فَأَتْبَعَهُ شِهَابٌ مُّبِينٌ ۚ
And We have placed within the heaven great stars (or, constellations) and have beautified it for the observers. And We protected it from every accursed/expelled devil, except one who steals a hearing and is pursued by a clear burning flame (or, visible flare). (15:16-18)

وَسَخَّرَ لَكُمُ اللَّيْلَ وَالنَّهَارَ وَالشَّمْسَ وَالْقَمَرَ وَالنُّجُومَ مُسَخَّرَاتٌ بِأَمْرِهِ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّقَوْمٍ يَعْقِلُونَ

And He has subjected for you the night and day and the sun and moon, and the stars are subjected by His command. Indeed in that are signs for a people who reason. (16:12)

وَجَعَلْنَا اللَّيْلَ وَالنَّهَارَ آيَتَيْنِ فَمَحَوْنَا آيَةَ اللَّيْلِ وَجَعَلْنَا آيَةَ النَّهَارِ مُبْصِرَةً لِّتَبْتَغُوا فَضْلًا مِّن رَّبِّكُمْ وَلِتَعْلَمُوا عَدَدَ السِّنِينَ وَالْحِسَابَ ۚ وَكُلَّ شَيْءٍ فَصَّلْنَاهُ تَفْصِيلًا

And We have made the night and day two signs, and We erased the sign of the night and made the sign of the day visible¹ that you may seek bounty from your Lord and may know the number of years and the account [of time]. And everything We have set out in detail. (17:12)

وَهُوَ الَّذِي خَلَقَ اللَّيْلَ وَالنَّهَارَ وَالشَّمْسَ وَالْقَمَرَ كُلٌّ فِي فَلَكٍ يَسْبَحُونَ

And it is He who created the night and the day and the sun and the moon; each in an orbit are swimming. (21:33)

“The sun with its own light and its own path and orbit and allotted time, and the moon which shines with a different light and travels on a different path and has its own allotted time. “Each in an orbit floating,” means revolving. Ibn Abbas said, “They revolve like a spinning wheel, in a circle.” This is like the Ayah (6:96). [Tafseer ibn Kathir]

تَبَارَكَ الَّذِي جَعَلَ فِي السَّمَاءِ بُرُوجًا وَجَعَلَ فِيهَا سِرَاجًا وَقَمَرًا مُّنِيرًا

Blessed is He who has placed in the sky great stars/constellations and placed therein a [burning] lamp and luminous moon (giving light). (25:61)

“This verse provides evidence that there is only one sun and one moon in the heaven. If there had been suns (stars) and moons besides this sun and this moon, Allah would have mentioned them in His Book...

They also provide the most eloquent refutation of the nonexistent claims of the tyrants of the Franks (Europeans) about suns and moons." [Al-Sawa'iq al-Shadeedah of al-Tuwaijri]

وَلَيْنَ سَأَلْتَهُمْ مَنْ خَلَقَ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ وَسَخَّرَ الشَّمْسَ وَالْقَمَرَ لِيَقُولَنَّ اللَّهُ فَأَنَّى يُؤْفَكُونَ

If you asked them, "Who created the heavens and earth and subjected the sun and the moon?" they would surely say, "Allah." Then how are they deluded? (29:61)

أَلَمْ تَرَ أَنَّ اللَّهَ يُولِجُ اللَّيْلَ فِي النَّهَارِ وَيُولِجُ النَّهَارَ فِي اللَّيْلِ وَسَخَّرَ الشَّمْسَ وَالْقَمَرَ كُلٌّ يَجْرِي إِلَى أَجَلٍ مُّسَمًّى وَأَنَّ اللَّهَ بِمَا تَعْمَلُونَ خَبِيرٌ
Do you not see [i.e., know] that Allah causes the night to enter/pass/merge into the day and causes the day to enter the night and has subjected the sun and the moon, each running [its course] for a specified term, and that Allah, of whatever you do, is Aware? (31:29)

يُولِجُ اللَّيْلَ فِي النَّهَارِ وَيُولِجُ النَّهَارَ فِي اللَّيْلِ وَسَخَّرَ الشَّمْسَ وَالْقَمَرَ كُلٌّ يَجْرِي لِأَجَلٍ مُّسَمًّى ۚ ذَلِكُمُ اللَّهُ رَبُّكُمْ لَهُ الْمُلْكُ ۚ وَالَّذِينَ تَدْعُونَ مِنْ دُونِهِ مَا يَمْلِكُونَ مِنْ قِطْمِيرٍ

He causes the night to enter the day, and He causes the day to enter the night and has subjected the sun and the moon - each running [its course] for a specified term. That is Allāh, your Lord; to Him belongs sovereignty. And those whom you invoke other than Him do not possess [as much as] the membrane of a date seed. (35:13)

وَأَيُّهُ لَهُمُ اللَّيْلُ نَسْلَخُ مِنْهُ النَّهَارَ فَإِذَا هُمْ مُظْلِمُونَ ۚ وَالشَّمْسُ تَجْرِي لِمُسْتَقَرٍّ لَهَا ۚ ذَٰلِكَ تَقْدِيرُ الْعَزِيزِ الْعَلِيمِ ۚ ۚ وَالْقَمَرَ قَدَرْنَاهُ مَنَازِلَ حَتَّىٰ عَادَ كَالْعُرْجُونِ الْقَدِيمِ ۚ لَا الشَّمْسُ يَنْبَغِي لَهَا أَنْ تُدْرِكَ الْقَمَرَ وَلَا اللَّيْلُ سَابِقُ النَّهَارِ ۚ وَكُلٌّ فِي فَلَكٍ يَسْبَحُونَ ۚ ۚ

And a sign for them is the night. We remove (strip, peel) from it the [light of] day, so they are [left] in darkness. And the sun runs [on course] toward its stopping point (or resting-place, or fixed term). That is the determination/design/measure of the Exalted in Might, the Knowing. And the moon - We have determined for it phases, until it returns [appearing] like the old date stalk. It is not allowable [i.e., possible] for the sun to reach/catch up with/overtake the moon, nor does the night overtake/outrun/outrunstrip the day, but each, in an orbit, is swimming.

(36:37-40)

عَنْ أَبِي ذَرٍّ قَالَ قَالَ النَّبِيُّ ﷺ لِأَبِي ذَرٍّ حِينَ غَرَبَتِ الشَّمْسُ " تَذَرِي أَيْنَ تَذْهَبُ ". قُلْتُ اللَّهُ وَرَسُولُهُ أَعْلَمُ. قَالَ " فَإِنَّهَا تَذْهَبُ حَتَّىٰ تَسْجُدَ تَحْتَ الْعَرْشِ، فَتَسْتَأْذِنَ فَيُؤْذَنَ لَهَا، وَيُوشِكُ أَنْ تَسْجُدَ فَلَا يُقْبَلُ مِنْهَا، وَتَسْتَأْذِنَ فَلَا يُؤْذَنَ لَهَا، يُقَالُ لَهَا ارْجِعِي مِنْ حَيْثُ جِئْتِ. فَتَطْلُعُ مِنْ مَغْرِبِهَا، فَذَٰلِكَ قَوْلُهُ تَعَالَىٰ {وَالشَّمْسُ تَجْرِي لِمُسْتَقَرٍّ لَهَا ذَٰلِكَ تَقْدِيرُ الْعَزِيزِ الْعَلِيمِ} ".

Narrated Abu Dharr: The Prophet ﷺ asked me at sunset, "Do you know where the sun goes?"

I replied, "Allah and His Apostle know better." He said, "It goes till it prostrates itself underneath the Throne and takes the permission to rise again, and it is permitted and then (a time will come when) it will be about to prostrate itself but its prostration will not be accepted, and it will ask permission to go on its course but it will not be permitted, but it will be ordered to return whence it has come and so it will rise in the west. And that is the interpretation of the Statement of Allah [tr.]: "And the sun runs [on course] toward its stopping point (or resting-place, or fixed term). That is the determination of the Exalted in Might, the Knowing."

(Sahih al-Bukhari 3199)

عَنْ أَبِي ذَرٍّ، قَالَ كُنْتُ رَدِيفَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ وَهُوَ عَلَىٰ حِمَارٍ وَالشَّمْسُ عِنْدَ غُرُوبِهَا فَقَالَ " هَلْ تَذَرِي أَيْنَ تَغْرُبُ هَذِهِ ". قُلْتُ اللَّهُ وَرَسُولُهُ أَعْلَمُ قَالَ " فَإِنَّهَا تَغْرُبُ فِي عَيْنٍ حَامِيَةٍ "

Narrated Abu Dharr: I was sitting behind the Messenger of Allah ﷺ who was riding a donkey while the sun was setting. He asked: "Do you know where this sets? I replied: Allah and his Apostle know best. He said: "It sets in a spring of warm water." (Sahih Sunan Abi Dawud 4002)

"The sun and the moon, all of that is in a circle, floating." [Tafseer al-Tabari 17/23]

Ibn Abbas said: "In an orbit (falak) like the orbit of the spindle." [Tafseer al-Tabari 23/8]

Qatadah said: "The orbit is a circle in the sky revolving around the stars while the sky is fixed." [Tafseer al-Qurtubi 11/286]

"That is, they revolve in the orbit of the sky. This was said by ibn Abbas, Ikrimah, al-Dhahhak, Hasan, Qatadah, and Ata' al-Khurasani." [Tafseer ibn Kathir 3/574]

إِنَّا زَيْنَّا السَّمَاءَ الدُّنْيَا بِزِينَةِ الْكَوَاكِبِ ٦ وَحِفْظًا مِّنْ كُلِّ شَيْطَانٍ مَّارِدٍ ٧ لَا يَسْمَعُونَ إِلَى الْمَلَأِ الْأَعْلَىٰ وَيُقَذَّفُونَ مِنْ كُلِّ جَانِبٍ ٨ دُحُورًا ٩ وَلَهُمْ عَذَابٌ وَاصِبٌ ٩ إِلَّا مَنْ خَطِفَ الْخَطْفَةَ فَأَتْبَعَهُ شِهَابٌ ثَاقِبٌ ١٠

Indeed, We have adorned the nearest heaven with an adornment of stars/planets. And as protection against every rebellious devil [so] they may not listen to the exalted assembly [of angels] and are pelted from every side (by flaming meteors), repelled; and for them is a constant punishment, except one who snatches [some words] by theft, but they are pursued by a burning flame, piercing [in brightness] (or, piercing flare). (37:6-10)

خَلَقَ السَّمُوتِ وَالْأَرْضَ بِالْحَقِّ ٥ يَكْوَرُ اللَّيْلُ عَلَى النَّهَارِ وَيَكْوَرُ النَّهَارُ عَلَى اللَّيْلِ ٦ وَسَخَّرَ الشَّمْسَ وَالْقَمَرَ ٧ كُلٌّ يَجْرِي لِأَجَلٍ مُّسَمًّى ٨ أَلَا هُوَ الْعَزِيزُ الْغَفُورُ

He created the heavens and earth in truth. He wraps the night over the day and wraps the day over the night and has subjected the sun and the moon, each running [its course] for a specified term. Unquestionably, He is the Exalted in Might, the Perpetual Forgiver. (39:5)

That is: He subjugated them, running one after the other without stopping, each of them seeking the other persistently, as in His saying: (He covers/overlaps the night with the day, [another night] chasing it rapidly) (7:54). This is the meaning of what was narrated on the authority of ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah, Al-Suddi, and others. [Tafseer ibn Kathir]

وَزَيْنَّا السَّمَاءَ الدُّنْيَا بِمَصَابِيحَ وَحِفْظٍ ١٢ ذَلِكَ تَقْدِيرُ الْعَزِيزِ الْعَلِيمِ

And We adorned the nearest heaven with lamps [i.e., stars, for beauty] and as protection. That is the determination of the Exalted in Might, the Knowing. (41:12)

الشَّمْسُ وَالْقَمَرُ بِحُسْبَانٍ

The sun and the moon [move/travel] by precise calculation (or, are made punctual). (55:5)

فَلَا أُقْسِمُ بِمَوَاقِعِ النُّجُومِ

Then I swear by the setting/places/positions of the stars (56:75)

وَلَقَدْ زَيْنَّا السَّمَاءَ الدُّنْيَا بِمَصَابِيحَ وَجَعَلْنَاهَا رُجُومًا لِلشَّيَاطِينِ ٥ وَأَعْتَدْنَا لَهُمْ عَذَابَ السَّعِيرِ

And We have certainly beautified the nearest heaven with lamps [i.e., stars] and have made [from] them what is thrown at the devils and have prepared for them the punishment of the Blaze. (67:5)

وَجَعَلَ الْقَمَرَ فِيهِنَّ نُورًا وَجَعَلَ الشَّمْسُ سِرَاجًا

And hath made the moon a light therein, and made the sun a lamp? (71:16)

وَأَنَّا لَمَسْنَا السَّمَاءَ فَوَجَدْنَاهَا مُلِئَتْ حَرَسًا شَدِيدًا وَشُهُبًا ٨ وَأَنَّا كُنَّا نَقْعُدُ مِنْهَا مَقْعَدًا لِّلْمُتَمِّعِ ٩ فَمَنْ يَسْتَمِعِ الْآنَ يَجِدْ لَهُ شِهَابًا رَّصَدًا ٩ وَأَنَّا لَا نَدْرِي أَشَرٌّ أُرِيدَ بِمَنْ فِي الْأَرْضِ أَمْ أَرَادَ بِهِمْ رَبُّهُمْ رَشَدًا ١٠

And (the Jinn who had listened to the Qur'an said): we have sought [to reach] the heaven but found it filled with powerful guards and burning flames (or, shooting stars). And we used to sit therein in positions for hearing, but whoever listens now will find a burning flame lying in wait for him. And we do not know [therefore] whether evil is intended for those on earth or whether their Lord intends for them a right course. (72:8-10)

وَحَسَفَ الْقَمَرُ ۙ وَجُمِعَ الشَّمْسُ وَالْقَمَرُ ۚ ٩

And the moon darkens (or is dimmed/eclipsed). And the sun and the moon are joined/brought together (they both will rise from the west and lose their light). (75:9)

وَجَعَلْنَا سِرَاجًا وَهَّاجًا

And made [therein] a burning lamp (78:13)

إِذَا الشَّمْسُ كُوِّرَتْ ۙ ١ وَإِذَا النُّجُومُ انْكَدَرَتْ ۙ ٢

When the sun is wrapped up [in darkness] (or, overthrown/put out) And when the stars fall, dispersing (81:1-2)

فَلَا أُقْسِمُ بِالْخُنُوسِ ۙ ١٥ أَلْجَوَارِ الْكُنَّسِ ۙ ١٦ وَاللَّيْلِ إِذَا عَسْعَسَ ۙ ١٧ وَالصُّبْحِ إِذَا تَنَفَّسَ ۙ ١٨

So I swear by the retreating/receding stars/planets - Those that run [their courses] and disappear [i.e., set] (or which travel and hide, or which rise and set), And by the night as it closes in/falls/departs, And by the dawn when it breathes [i.e., stirs] (81:15-18)

وَالشَّمْسُ وَضُحْلَهَا ۙ ١ وَالْقَمَرُ إِذَا تَلَّهَا ۙ ٢

By the sun and its brightness and [by] the moon when it follows it. (91:1-2)

عَنْ صَفْوَانَ بْنِ عَسَّالٍ، قَالَ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ " إِنَّ مِنْ قِبَلِ مَغْرِبِ الشَّمْسِ بَابًا مَفْتُوحًا عَرْضُهُ سَبْعُونَ سَنَةً فَلَا يَزَالُ ذَلِكَ الْبَابُ مَفْتُوحًا لِلتَّوْبَةِ حَتَّى تَطْلُعَ الشَّمْسُ مِنْ نَحْوِهِ فَإِذَا طَلَعَتْ مِنْ نَحْوِهِ لَمْ يَنْفَعْ نَفْسًا إِيْمَانُهَا لَمْ تَكُنْ آمَنَتْ مِنْ قَبْلُ أَوْ كَسَبَتْ فِي إِيْمَانِهَا خَيْرًا "

It was narrated from Safwan bin 'Assal that the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said: "Towards the west (i.e., the place of the setting of the sun) there is an open door, seventy years wide. That door will remain open for repentance until the sun rises from this direction. When it rises from this direction, faith will not benefit any soul that did not believe before or earn anything good through its faith." (Sahih Ibn Majah 4070)

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ - رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ - عَنِ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ " أَوَّلُ زُمْرَةٍ تَدْخُلُ الْجَنَّةَ عَلَى صُورَةِ الْقَمَرِ لَيْلَةَ الْبَدْرِ، وَالَّذِينَ عَلَى أَنَارِهِمْ كَأَحْسَنِ كَوْكَبٍ دُرِّيٍّ فِي السَّمَاءِ إِضَاءَةً، قُلُوبُهُمْ عَلَى قَلْبِ رَجُلٍ وَاحِدٍ، لَا تَبَاغُضُ بَيْنَهُمْ وَلَا تَحَاسَدُ، لِكُلِّ امْرِئٍ زَوْجَتَانِ مِنَ الْحُورِ الْعِينِ، يُرَى مَخُ سَوْفِيْنَ مِنْ وَرَاءِ الْعِظَمِ وَاللَّحْمِ "

Narrated Abu Huraira: The Prophet ﷺ said, "The first batch (of people) who will enter Paradise will be (glittering) like the full moon, and the batch next to them will be (glittering) like the most brilliant star in the sky. (Sahih al-Bukhari 3254)

"These hadiths are evidence that the light of the greatest planet (kawkab) in the sky does not reach the same level as the light of the moon, let alone the light of the sun. For this reason, the first group of the people of Paradise will be like the moon, and the second group will be like the brightest planet in the sky. If the matter were as claimed by the proponents of modern astronomy, that the fixed stars are suns like this sun or larger than it, then the second group of the people of Paradise would be better than the first group and far more luminous than them. This is absolutely false, and authentic hadiths refute it. [Al-Sawa'iq al-Shadeedah of al-Tuwaijri]

حَدَّثَنِي سُلَيْمُ بْنُ عَامِرٍ، حَدَّثَنَا الْمُفَضَّلُ، صَاحِبُ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالَ سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ يَقُولُ " إِذَا كَانَ يَوْمُ الْقِيَامَةِ أُدْنِيَتْ

الشَّمْسُ مِنَ الْعِبَادِ حَتَّى تَكُونَ قِيدَ مِيلٍ أَوْ اثْنَيْنِ " . قَالَ سُلَيْمٌ لَا أَدْرِي أَيَّ الْمِيلَيْنِ عَنَى أَمْسَافَةَ الْأَرْضِ أَمْ الْمِيلَ الَّذِي تُكْتَحَلُ بِهِ الْعَيْنُ قَالَ " فَتَصْنَهُرُهُمُ الشَّمْسُ فَيَكُونُونَ فِي الْعَرَقِ بِقَدْرِ أَعْمَالِهِمْ

"Miqdad said: I heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ saying: 'On the Day of Judgement, the sun will be drawn near the servants, until it has come a mile or two (away).'" Sulaim bin 'Amir said:

"I do not know if it is miles that refer to distance on the land, or al-Mil which is used to apply Kuhl for the eyes." The Prophet ﷺ: "The sun will melt them, until they will be in sweat

according to their deeds." (Sahih al-Tirmidhi 2421)

عَنْ عَطِيَّةَ، عَنْ أَبِي سَعِيدٍ، عَنِ النَّبِيِّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ قَالَ " إِنَّ أَوَّلَ زُمْرَةٍ يَدْخُلُونَ الْجَنَّةَ يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ ضَوْءٌ وَجُوهُهُمْ عَلَى مِثْلِ ضَوْءِ الْقَمَرِ لَيْلَةَ الْبَدْرِ وَالزُّمَرَةُ الثَّانِيَةُ عَلَى مِثْلِ أَحْسَنِ كَوْكَبٍ دُرِّيٍّ فِي السَّمَاءِ لِكُلِّ رَجُلٍ مِنْهُمْ زَوْجَتَانِ عَلَى كُلِّ زَوْجَةٍ سَبْعُونَ حُلَّةً يُرَى مَخُّ سَاقِهَا مِنْ وَرَائِهَا "

Abu Sa'eed al-Khudri narrated that the Prophet ﷺ said: "Indeed the first batch to enter Paradise will appear like the moon of a night that is full. The second will appear like the color of the most beautiful (brightest) star in the sky. Each man among them shall have two wives, each wife wearing seventy bracelets, with the marrow of their shins being visible from behind them." (Sahih al-Tirmidhi 2735)

"This hadith indicates that the light of all the planets (kawakib) cannot withstand the light of the sun, let alone that there is something among them that is larger than the sun and much more luminous than it. This hadith and the hadiths before it refute those who speculate about the planets and claim things based on them that have no basis other than false assumptions." [Al-Sawa'iq al-Shadeedah of al-Tuwaijri]

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ قَالَ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ : " غَزَا نَبِيٌّ مِنَ الْأَنْبِيَاءِ ... فَعَزَا قَدَنًا مِنَ الْقَرْيَةِ صَلَاةَ الْعَصْرِ أَوْ قَرِيبًا مِنْ ذَلِكَ فَقَالَ لِلشَّمْسِ إِنَّكَ مَأْمُورَةٌ وَأَنَا مَأْمُورٌ، اللَّهُمَّ احْبِسْهَا عَلَيْنَا. فَحُبِسَتْ، حَتَّى فَتَحَ اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ... "

The Prophet ﷺ said, "A prophet amongst the prophets carried out a holy military expedition... and when he reached that town at the time or nearly at the time of the `Asr prayer, he said to the sun, 'O sun! You are under Allah's Order and I am under Allah's Order. O Allah! Stop it (i.e. the sun) from setting.' It was stopped till Allah made him victorious..." (Sahih al-Bukhari 3124)

عن أبي هريرة، قال: قال رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم: «إِنَّ الشَّمْسَ لَمْ تُحْبَسْ عَلَى بَشَرٍ إِلَّا لِيُوشَعَ لِيَالِي سَارَ إِلَى بَيْتِ الْمُقَدَّسِ». The Prophet ﷺ said: "The sun was never held (from setting) for any human except Yusha' [bin Nun], on the nights he marched to Jerusalem." (Sahih Musnad Ahmad)

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ - رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ - عَنِ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ قَالَ " الشَّمْسُ وَالْقَمَرُ مُكَوَّرَانِ يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ " Narrated Abu Huraira: The Prophet ﷺ said, "The sun and the moon will be folded up on the Day of Resurrection." (Sahih al-Bukhari 3200)

تحشر الأيام على هيئتها، وتحشر الجمعة زهراء منيرة، أهلها يحفون بها كالعروس تهدي إلى خدرها، تضئ لهم يمشون في ضوئها، ألوانهم كالثلج بياضاً، وريحهم كالمسك، يخوضون في جبال الكافور، ينظر إليهم الثقلان لا يطرقون تعجباً حتى يدخلون الجنة، لا يخالطهم أحد إلا المؤذنون المحتسبون

"The days shall be gathered in their [original] form, and al-Jumu'ah shall be gathered as radiant and illuminating. Its people surround it like a bride being led to her bridal chamber; it shines for them, and they walk in its light. Their complexions are as white as snow, and their fragrance is like musk. They wade through mountains of camphor. The Thaqaalayn look upon them without

looking away in amazement until they enter Paradise. No one shall mingle with them except for the callers of *Adhan* who seek their reward [from Allah alone]." (Sahih al-Jaami' 706, Mustadrak al-Hakim 1027 - Sahih)

- إِنَّ اللَّهَ : يَبْعَثُ الْأَيَّامَ يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ عَلَى هَيْئَتِهَا ، وَيَبْعَثُ الْجُمُعَةَ زَهْرَاءَ مُنِيرَةً لِأَهْلِهَا ، فَيَحْفُونَ بِهَا كَالْعُرُوسِ تُهْدَى إِلَى كَرِيمِهَا تُضِيءُ لَهُمْ ، يَمْشُونَ فِي ضَوْئِهَا ، أَلْوَانُهُمْ كَالْتَّلَاجِ بَيَاضًا ، رِيَاخُهُمْ تَسْطَعُ كَالْمِسْكِ

"Indeed, Allah resurrects the days on the Day of Resurrection in their [original] form, and He resurrects Friday as radiant and illuminating for its people. They surround it like a bride being led to her noble [groom]; it shines for them, and they walk in its light. Their complexions are as white as snow, and their scent wafts like musk. (Sahih al-Jaami' 1872)

"The greatest proof that day possesses its own light, independent of the sun, is that Paradise experiences a day without sun... All of this proves that the day possesses its own light, independent of the sun."
[Al-Hawi lil-Fatawa of al-Suyuti]

THE WHALE & BULL

نَ وَالْقَلَمَ وَمَا يَسْطُرُونَ

Nūn. By the pen and what they inscribe (68:1)

وَأَخْرَجَ ابْنُ جَرِيرٍ، وَالطَّبْرَانِيُّ، وَابْنُ مَرْدَوَيْهِ، عَنْ ابْنِ عَبَّاسٍ قَالَ : قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ : - إِنَّ أَوَّلَ مَا خَلَقَ اللَّهُ الْقَلَمَ وَالْحُوتَ قَالَ: اكْتُبْ، قَالَ: مَا أَكْتُبُ؟ قَالَ: كُلُّ شَيْءٍ كَانِي إِلَى يَوْمِ الْقِيَامَةِ» ثُمَّ قَرَأَ: نَ وَالْقَلَمَ وَمَا يَسْطُرُونَ فَالْتَنُونُ الْحُوتَ، وَالْقَلَمَ الْقَلَمَ

Ibn Abbas said: The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: "Verily the first thing Allah created was the pen and the whale. He said: 'Write.' It said: 'What should I write?' He said: 'Everything which will be until the Day of Resurrection.' Then he recited: "Nun. And the pen and what they inscribe." So the Nūn is the whale, and the qalam is the pen." (Narrated by al-Tabari, al-Tabarani, Ibn Marduyah, and in al-Durr al-Manthuri - Sahih)

وَأَخْرَجَ ابْنُ أَبِي حَاتِمٍ، وَالْحَاكِمُ وَصَحَّحَهُ - وَتَعَقَّبَهُ الذَّهَبِيُّ فَقَالَ : مُنْكَرٌ - عَنْ ابْنِ عَمْرٍو قَالَ : قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ - صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ - : «إِنَّ الْأَرْضَيْنِ بَيْنَ كُلِّ أَرْضٍ وَالتِّي تَلِيهَا مَسِيرَةُ خَمْسِمِائَةِ عَامٍ، وَالْعُلْيَا مِنْهَا عَلَى ظَهْرِ حُوتٍ قَدْ اتَّقَى طَرْفَاهُ فِي السَّمَاءِ، وَالْحُوتُ عَلَى صَخْرَةٍ، وَالصَّخْرَةُ بِيَدِ مَلَكٍ

Ibn Amr said: The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: "Verily the earths, between every earth and the one who follows it there is the travel distance of five hundred years. And the highest one of them is upon the back of a whale whose flippers meet in the heaven. And the whale is upon a rock, and the rock is in the hand of an angel. (Narrated by Ibn Abi Hatim – Sahih by al-Hakim)

وَأُخْبِرْتُ بِأَنَّ عَبْدَ اللَّهِ بْنَ سَلَامٍ سَأَلَ النَّبِيَّ ﷺ : عَلَى مَا الْحُوتُ؟ قَالَ: «عَلَى مَاءٍ أَسْوَدَ، وَمَا أَخَذَ مِنْهُ الْحُوتُ إِلَّا كَمَا أَخَذَ حُوتٌ مِنْ حَيْثَانِكُمْ مِنْ بَحْرِ مِنْ هَذِهِ الْبَحَارِ

Abdullah ibn Salam asked the Prophet ﷺ: 'What is the whale upon?' He ﷺ said: 'Upon black water. And the whale has not taken from it, except what the whale from your whales take from an ocean among these oceans (of the dunya).' (Al-Durr al-Manthuri)

"Mujahid said: "Nun: is the whale which is beneath the seventh earth. And the qalam (pen) is that which the dhikr is written down with." [Al-Durr al-Manthur]

"Ibn Abbas said: "The first thing Allah created was the pen. He said (to it): 'Write.' It said: 'What should I write?' He said: 'Write the Qadar.' He said: So it ran (i.e. it wrote) what would occur from that day until the establishment of the Hour. Then He created the Nun (i.e. the whale). And He lifted up the smoke of the water and the heaven were split (into seven) from it. And the earth was spread out upon the back of the Nun. Then the Nun shook and the earth moved, so it was made firm with mountains. And verily do they (i.e. the mountains) boast (about this) to the earth." [Mustadrak al-Hakim 3840 - Sahih]

"Zayd ibn Aslam claimed that one of the prophets said to them [their people], "Verily, the earth is on a whale," and a man disbelieved. So he sat down on the seashore, and a whale the size of a hill swam by, and he asked: Is this it? He said: No. Then another whale swam by, the size of which I do not know. He asked: Is this it? He said: No. Then another swam by from morning until midday, and he asked: Is this it? He said: No. Indeed, that whale eats seven thousand like this every day." [Al-Radd ala al-Jahniyyah of ibn Abi Hatim al-Razi p. 153]

لَهُ مَا فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَمَا فِي الْأَرْضِ وَمَا بَيْنَهُمَا وَمَا تَحْتَ الثَّرَىٰ

To Him belongs what is in the heavens and what is on the earth and what is between them and what is under the soil. (20:6)

"Then the Lord exalted Himself and said: "To Him belongs whatever is in the heavens, and on the earth, and whatever is between them, and whatever is under the earth." - the "earth" meaning the lower earth, and under it, the rock, the angel, the bull, the whale, the water, and the wind blowing in the air." [Tafseer Muqatil ibn Sulayman]

وَأَخْرَجَ ابْنَ أَبِي حَاتِمٍ ، وَالْحَاكِمُ وَصَحَّحَهُ - وَتَعَقَّبَهُ الدَّهَبِيُّ فَقَالَ : مُنْكَرٌ - عَنِ ابْنِ عَمْرٍو قَالَ : قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ : «إِنَّ الْأَرْضَيْنِ بَيْنَ كُلِّ أَرْضٍ وَالَّتِي تَلِيهَا مَسِيرَةُ خَمْسِمِائَةِ عَامٍ، وَالْعُلْيَا مِنْهَا عَلَى ظَهْرِ حُوتٍ قَدِ اتَّقَى طَرَفَاهُ فِي السَّمَاءِ، وَالْحُوتُ عَلَى صَخْرَةٍ، وَالصَّخْرَةُ بِيَدِ مَلَكٍ وَالثَّانِيَةُ : مَسْجِنُ الرِّيحِ، فَلَمَّا أَرَادَ اللَّهُ أَنْ يُهْلِكَ عَادًا أَمَرَ خَازِنَ الرِّيحِ أَنْ يُرْسِلَ عَلَيْهِمْ رِيحًا تُفْلِكُ عَادًا، فَقَالَ : يَا رَبِّ، أُرْسِلْ عَلَيْهِمْ مِنَ الرِّيحِ قَدْرَ مَنْخَرِ الثَّوْرِ؟ فَقَالَ لَهُ الْجَبَّارُ : إِذْنُ تُكْفَأُ الْأَرْضُ وَمَنْ عَلَيْهَا، وَلَكِنْ أُرْسِلْ عَلَيْهِمْ بِقَدْرِ خَاتَمٍ، فَهِيَ الَّتِي قَالَ اللَّهُ فِي كِتَابِهِ : مَا تَذَرُ مِنْ شَيْءٍ أَتَتْ عَلَيْهِ إِلَّا جَعَلْنَاهُ كَالرَّمِيمِ [51:42] وَالثَّلَاثَةُ : فِيهَا جِبَارَةُ جَهَنَّمَ.

وَالرَّابِعَةُ : فِيهَا كِبْرِيَتْ جَهَنَّمَ» قَالُوا : يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ؟ أَلِلنَّارِ كِبْرِيَتْ؟ قَالَ : «نَعَمْ، وَالَّذِي نَفْسِي بِيَدِهِ إِنَّ فِيهَا لِأَوْدِيَةً مِنْ كِبْرِيَتْ، لَوْ أُرْسِلَ فِيهَا الْجِبَالُ الرَّوَاسِي لَمَاعَتْ» وَالْخَامِسَةُ : فِيهَا حَيَاتُ جَهَنَّمَ، إِنَّ أَفْوَاهَهَا كَالْأَوْدِيَةِ، تَلْسَعُ الْكَافِرَ اللَّسْعَةَ فَلَا يَبْقَى مِنْهُ لَحْمٌ عَلَى وَضْمٍ. وَالسَّادِسَةُ : فِيهَا عَمَارِبُ جَهَنَّمَ، إِنَّ أَدْنَى عَقْرَبَةٍ مِنْهَا كَالْبِغَالِ الْمُوَكَّفَةِ، تَضْرِبُ الْكَافِرَ ضَرْبَةً يَنْسِيهِ ضَرْهُمَا حَرَّ جَهَنَّمَ. وَالسَّابِعَةُ : فِيهَا سَفَرٌ، وَفِيهَا إِبْلِيسُ مُصَفَّدٌ بِالْحَدِيدِ، يَدُ أَمَامِهِ وَيَدُ خَلْفَهُ، فَإِذَا أَرَادَ اللَّهُ أَنْ يُطْلِقَهُ لِمَا يَشَاءُ أَطْلَقَهُ.

Ibn Amr said: The Messenger of Allah said: "Verily the earths, between every earth and the one who follows it there is the travel distance of five hundred years. And the highest one of them is upon the back of a whale whose flippers meet in the heaven. And the whale is upon a rock, and the rock is in the hand of an angel. And the second (earth) is a confinement for the wind. So when Allah wanted to destroy Aad, He ordered the keeper of the wind to send a wind upon them which would destroy Aad. So he said: 'O my Lord. Should I send a wind upon them at the size of the nostril of the bull?' So al-Jabbar said to him: 'Then the earth and whoever I upon it

would be turned upside down. Rather send upon them a wind at the size of a ring.’ And that (ring) is the one about which Allah said (tr.): “It spared nothing that it reached, but blew it into broken spreads of rotten ruins.” (51:42)

And the third: In it are the rocks of Jahannam. And the fourth: In it is the sulfur of Jahannam.’

They said: ‘Oh Messenger of Allah, does Hellfire have sulfur?’ He said: ‘Yes, by the One in Whose Hand my soul is in. It verily has a valley of sulfur. If the affixed mountains were thrown into it, they would have become liquid. And the fifth: In it are the snakes of Jahannam. Verily their mouths are like valleys. They will bite the kāfir with a bite, so none of his meat will remain on the meat block. And the sixth: In it are the scorpions of Jahannam. Verily the smallest scorpion of them is like (the size of) a saddled mule. It will sting the kafir with a sting, which he will forget due to the heat of Jahannam. And the seventh: In it is Hellfire. And in it Iblees is shackled in iron; a hand in front of him and a hand behind him. Then when Allah wants to free him for whatever (reason) He wants, He sets him free.’” (Mustadrak al-Hakim - Sahih)

THE MOUNTAIN QAAF

قَافٌ وَالْقُرْآنُ الْمَجِيدُ

Qaaf. By the glorious Quran! (50:1)

“And from his narration on the authority of ibn Abbas that he said in the interpretation of Allah’s saying, “Qaaf.” He said: it is an azure mountain overlooking this world, and the colour of the sky takes from it; Allah swore by it, and He swore by the glorious, noble Quran.” [Tafseer ibn Abbas]

Abd al-Razzaq narrated from ibn Jurayj, from Mujahid, regarding the statement of Allah - Exalted is He: “{Qaaf} – A mountain that surrounds the earth.” [Tafsir Abd al-Razzaq]

From ibn Abbas, he said: “Allah created behind this earth an ocean surrounding it. Then He created behind that a mountain called Qaaf — the lowest heaven is spread out over it. Then He created behind that mountain an earth like this earth, seven times. Then He created behind that an ocean surrounding it. Then He created behind that a mountain called Qaaf — the second heaven is spread out over it. Until he counted seven earths, seven oceans, seven mountains, and seven heavens.” He said: “And that is His statement: “And the ocean, seven oceans add to it” (31:27).” [Tafsir Ibn Abi Hatim]

“Ibn Zayd, Ikrinah, and al-Dhahhak said it is a mountain surrounding the Earth, made of green emerald, from which the sky derives its green color. The ends of the sky rest upon it, and the sky is vaulted over it. Any emerald that people acquire is from what has fallen from that mountain. This was narrated by Abu al-Jawza from Abdullah ibn Abbas. [Tafseer al-Qurtubi]

“Qaaf is a mountain made of green emeralds surrounding the world. The greenness of the sky is from it, and nothing of creation is like its creation. And the mountains grow from it, and it is behind the mountains, and the veins of all the mountains are from Qaaf. So when Allah wills for an earthquake, He inspires the angel with Him to move a vein of the mountain, and the earth He wants shakes. It is the first mountain ever created, then Abu Qubays after it, which is the mountain beneath which is Safa.

And besides Qaaf, a year's journey away, is a mountain where the sun sets, called al-Hijab. This is Allah's saying: {until it [the sun] disappeared into the hijab [of darkness]} meaning by the mountain, and it is behind the hijab, and it has a face like a human face and a heart like the hearts of angels in fear of Allah. It is behind the hijab behind which the sun disappears, and the hijab besides Qaaf is a year's journey away, and between them is darkness, and the sun sets behind the hijab at the base of the mountain. This is what Allah says: (Until it [the sun] disappeared into the hijab) (38:32) meaning by the mountain. This is what Allah says in Maryam: (So she took, in seclusion from them, a hijab)." (19:17)
[Tafseer Muqatil ibn Sulayman 4/109]

ISRA'ILIYYAAT (JEWISH LORE)

عن ابن عباسٍ قَالَ وَضَعَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ يَدَهُ بَيْنَ كَتِفَيَّ أَوْ قَالَ عَلَى مَنْكِبِي فَقَالَ اللَّهُمَّ فَقِّهُهُ فِي الدِّينِ وَعَلِّمَهُ التَّأْوِيلَ
 Ibn Abbas reported: The Messenger of Allah ﷺ put his hand on my shoulder and he said, "O Allah, give him understanding in religion and teach him the interpretation of the Quran."
 (Musnad Ahmad 2879)

يُحَدِّثُ عَنْ ابْنِ عَبَّاسٍ، أَنَّهُ سَأَلَ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ عَنْ رَجُلٍ قَالَ " مَنْ وَضَعَ هَذَا " . فِي رِوَايَةٍ زُهَيْرٍ قَالُوا . وَفِي رِوَايَةِ أَبِي بَكْرٍ قُلْتُ ابْنُ عَبَّاسٍ . قَالَ " اللَّهُمَّ فَقِّهُهُ " .

Ibn Abbas reported that Allah's Messenger ﷺ came to privy and I placed for him water for ablution, When he came out he said: Who placed it here? And in a version of Zuhair they (the Companions) said, and in the version of Abu Bakr (the words are): I said: It is Ibn Abbas (who has done that), whereupon he (the Holy Prophet) said: May Allah grant him deep understanding of religion. (Sahih Muslim 2477)

Ibn Abbas said, "Why do you ask the people of the scripture about anything while your Book (the Quran) which has been revealed to Allah's Messenger ﷺ is newer and the latest? You read it pure, undistorted and unchanged, and Allah has told you that the People of the Book changed their scripture and distorted it, and wrote the scripture with their own hands and said, 'It is from Allah,' to sell it for a little gain. Does not the knowledge which has come to you prevent you from asking them about anything? No, by Allah, we have never seen any man from them asking you regarding what has been revealed to you!"
[Sahih al-Bukhari 7363]

Ibn Abbas said: "I asked thirty companions of the Prophet ﷺ about one question." [Siyar I'lam al-Nubala of al-Dhahabi 3/344 - Sahih]

"One day ibn Abbas was sitting when a man came to him and said: Oh ibn Abbas, I heard something strange mentioned from Ka'b al-Ahbar about the sun and the moon. He said: He was reclining and became excited, then he said: What is that? He said: He claimed that the sun and the moon would be brought on the Day of Resurrection as if they were executed/sacrificed bulls, and they would be thrown into Hell. Ikrimah said: Ibn Abbas became very angry, then he said: Ka'b lied! Ka'b lied! Ka'b lied! (three times) Rather, this is Judaism that he wants to bring into Islam. Allah is too great and too generous for something to be punished for obedience to Him.

Have you not heard the words of Allah, Blessed and Most High? (And He subjected for you the sun and the moon, continuous [in orbit], and subjected for you the night and the day) (14:33). What he means is their diligence in obedience, so how can he torture two servants whom he praises for being diligent in obeying him?! May Allah kill this scholar/rabbi and disgrace his rabbiship! How bold he is against Allah and how great his accusations are against these two obedient servants of Allah! He said: He repeated the istirja' for a while... Then he raised his head and threw the stick and said: Shall I not tell you about what I heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say about the sun and the moon, the beginning of their creation, and the fate of their affairs?" [Tafseer al-Thalabi 16/295; Tarikh al-Tabari 1/65; Kitab al-Adhamah]

Al-Tirmidhi said: "What is transmitted from Mujahid, Qatadah and other scholars regarding the interpretation of the Quran - it cannot be thought that they did this without knowledge, or on their own. What is transmitted from them testifies to what we said, that they did not speak on their own or without knowledge." [Sunan al-Tirmidhi 2952]

"It cannot be that ibn Abbas relied on the reports of the People of the Book, since he himself was one of those who forbade us from asking them, and the Prophet ﷺ also forbade us from confirming or denying their reports." [Bayan Talbis al-Jahnniyyah of ibn Taymiyyah 6/448]